Everyday AI: Home & family

20 step-by-step guides for real, everyday tasks

Home & family

Updated: November 8, 2026

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Before you start — what this is, honestly

This is an updated edition. It was rebuilt from our current guides on the date shown on the cover: more guides per topic, retired guides removed, and every step taken from the latest version of each guide.

This collection is free, and every guide in it is also free on our website. This file just gathers them in one place, in reading order, so you can print it, keep it on your phone, or read it offline. Our website has no paywall either — every guide links back to its online page, which is always the newer version.

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Apps change. Buttons move and menus get renamed. If a step does not match what you see, the guide's online version is the newer one — the link is under every title.

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Home & family

Plan a Family Weekend Getaway with DeepSeek: A Step-by-Step Guide

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** DeepSeek can draft a full weekend itinerary for your family — kid-friendly activities, meal stops, rough travel times — in under five minutes. It does the brainstorming and structuring; you still book the hotels, tickets and restaurants yourself.

Picture this: it's a Wednesday evening, the kids are finally asleep, and you're trying to figure out where to go this Saturday and Sunday. DeepSeek — the free AI chatbot from the Chinese AI lab DeepSeek — can act like a brainstorming travel buddy. Tell it who is coming, where you're starting from, and how much you want to spend, and it returns a tidy day-by-day plan you can actually use.

Before you start

- A free DeepSeek account (sign up at deepseek.com with an email address — no payment needed for the chat feature).
- The DeepSeek mobile app, or any web browser on a phone or computer.
- About 15–20 minutes, mostly waiting for the AI to type.
- Optional but useful: a notes app on your phone (Apple Notes, Google Keep, etc.) so you can save the final plan.

Step 1 — Open DeepSeek and start a new chat

Open the DeepSeek app or go to **deepseek.com** in your browser. Sign in with the account you just created. You'll see a clean chat screen with a text box at the bottom — it's intentionally simple, looking similar to most messaging apps. Tap that text box once, and your keyboard slides up, ready for typing. If you've used DeepSeek before, look for a small **"New Chat"** icon (often a pencil or plus sign) at the top of the screen so you start with a blank conversation. Starting fresh matters — the AI will remember earlier messages in the same chat and may get confused by leftovers from old trips.

💬 Example: just type the word **"Hi"** for now to make sure the box works.

You'll know it worked when a response starts streaming in within a few seconds.

Step 2 — Tell DeepSeek the basics of your trip

In the chat box, write a short paragraph that names the essentials: who's going, where you're starting from, the weekend dates, and what kind of trip you want (relaxing, active, food-focused,

somewhere new). The more concrete you are here, the better the plan will be. Press **Enter** or tap the send arrow. DeepSeek usually replies in a few seconds — it does not browse the live web for this kind of question, so it won't know current hotel prices, but it will use its general knowledge of cities, neighborhoods and family activities. Think of this message like giving a friend the brief before they make suggestions.

Example: *"We're a family of four — two adults, a 7-year-old and a 10-year-old — based in Chicago. We want to drive somewhere within 3 hours for the weekend of 14–15 June. We love outdoorsy stuff and kid-friendly museums. Budget is medium."*

You'll know it worked when DeepSeek writes back with one or two clarifying questions or an early outline of ideas.

Step 3 — Ask for a day-by-day itinerary

Now ask for the structured plan you actually came for. Be specific that you want a **day-by-day** schedule, **kid-friendly** activities, and **rough travel times** between stops. Press send and let it write. You'll see the answer appear paragraph by paragraph — the response can be quite long for this kind of request, so give it a moment to finish. If the answer is heading the wrong direction (too many hikes, only adult restaurants), you don't need to start over — just tell it what to change in the next step. If you ever want a shorter summary, type "summarize that" and it will condense the plan into a few lines.

Example: *"Please make a day-by-day itinerary for Saturday and Sunday. For each day, give me morning, midday and afternoon activities that work for kids aged 7 and 10. Add rough drive times between stops."*

You'll know it worked when you see a clearly labeled "Saturday" and "Sunday" section with specific times or blocks.

Step 4 — Add meals, budget notes and a backup plan

The first plan is usually solid but a bit bare on food and money. Send a follow-up message in the same chat asking for restaurant suggestions that welcome kids, an estimated cost for the day, and a simple rainy-day backup. DeepSeek keeps the whole conversation in mind, so it builds on what it just suggested. Watch for the reply to come in the same chat window — no need to refresh or start a new thread. If it suggests a fancy tasting-menu place, just say "make meals more casual, kid menus only" and it will revise. This step turns a generic plan into one that fits your actual family instead of an imagined one.

Example: *"Add lunch and dinner suggestions for each day — nothing too fancy, kids need to see familiar food on the menu. Estimate the total daily cost for our family of four, and give me*

a backup indoor plan in case it rains."

You'll know it worked when the new reply includes named restaurants or food types, a rough dollar figure per day, and an alternative activity for each day.

Step 5 — Refine the plan with focused follow-ups

This is where DeepSeek really earns its keep: you can keep tweaking the same plan without starting over. Ask narrow questions like "is there a shorter drive option?" or "swap the museum for something more outdoorsy." Press send after each question and read the reply before sending the next one — the chat history stays short, so you don't have to scroll far. If the assistant suggests something you don't recognize (a town name, a small park, a museum), quickly search it on your phone to confirm it's real and open on your dates. AI sometimes invents place names that sound convincing but don't actually exist, especially for lesser-known spots.

Example: *"Swap the Sunday morning museum for an outdoor activity — the kids get restless indoors. Also, can you suggest a town within 2 hours of Chicago instead of 3?"*

You'll know it worked when the revised plan reflects every change you asked for, in the same chat thread, with no contradictions from earlier suggestions.

Step 6 — Save the plan outside the chat

Once the plan looks good, get it out of the chat window — old chats can disappear after app updates, and you don't want to lose your weekend to a glitch. Tap and hold inside the answer (on mobile) or highlight it (on desktop) and choose **Copy**. Then paste the whole thing into a notes app, a Google Doc, or your family's group chat. If the plan is very long, copy it in two parts to avoid truncation. Some versions of DeepSeek also show a small **share icon** near a message — that creates a link you can send to your partner. Either way, the goal is simple: by the end of this step, the plan lives somewhere you can read it on Saturday morning without opening the AI again.

Example: copy the final plan, then paste it into a new note titled **"Family weekend — 14/15 June"**.

You'll know it worked when you can open your notes app and read the full itinerary without going back to DeepSeek.

Step 7 — Check the key details before you go

DeepSeek can't book anything, see live prices, or know if a museum is closed for renovations — so the last step is yours. Spend ten minutes verifying the big things: opening hours for any ticketed attraction, the restaurant is still serving on those dates, drive times on Google Maps, and

the weather forecast. If something is closed or sold out, ask DeepSeek in the same chat for a swap ("the aquarium is closed Sunday, what else works for kids that age?"). This quick check is the difference between a smooth weekend and showing up at a locked gate with tired kids.

💬 Example: type *"Quick check — can you remind me of the backup plan for Sunday if it rains? I want it in one short list."*

You'll know it worked when you have a confirmed plan in your notes, real opening hours in your calendar, and a fallback ready in case anything changes on the day.

Common mistakes

- **Asking a question that's too vague.** "Plan me a trip" gets a generic answer that doesn't fit your family. Always include the family size, ages of kids, starting city, dates and budget in the first message.
- **Trusting every place name without checking.** DeepSeek knows a lot, but it can invent small museums or restaurants that sound real. Google each venue before you drive there, especially for places you've never heard of.
- **Forgetting to mention budget.** Without a budget signal, the plan may lean toward expensive tasting menus and pricey hotels. Say "low", "medium" or "high" up front, and add a number if you have one in mind — it changes the suggestions a lot.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the same prompt style works for any weekend — birthday parties, day trips, visiting friends in another city. Once you have the rhythm, planning takes minutes instead of evenings.
- **For your business or work:** if you ever run team off-sites or client visits, you can paste the same brief and ask for a more grown-up version — swap "kids" for "teammates", "budget" for "company card", and the structure stays useful.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to ask DeepSeek for a one-day plan for *this* coming weekend, even if you don't take it. The practice of writing a clear brief is the actual skill — the trip is a bonus.

Try it now

Open DeepSeek, paste the exact prompt from Step 2 with your own city and dates, and see what it comes back with in under a minute. That's the whole skill: one good paragraph of context, and a useful plan follows.

How to plan a simple weekly meal prep with one AI-made grocery list

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** In a short chat, you can get a five-day meal plan, one combined grocery list, and a prep checklist built for your household. The key limit: the assistant doesn't know what's in your fridge or what's on sale, so you must check its quantities and adjust them.

Meal prep means cooking some of your food ahead of time so weekday dinners and lunches take less effort. This guide is for anyone who already chats with an AI assistant and wants to turn that habit into a weekly routine. By the end, you'll have a plan, a single shopping list, and a prep checklist you can reuse every week.

Before you start

- **An AI chat assistant** you already use to send messages. Any chat tool works the same way for this method.
- **A notes app or a sheet of paper** to save your final plan and list.
- **About 30 to 40 minutes** for the first run. Later weeks take much less, because you'll reuse your template.
- **Your household details**: how many people eat, how much time you have to cook, and any foods nobody eats.

Step 1 — Write down your household's rules

Before you ask for any plan, collect the facts the assistant needs. Open a new chat and type your details in one message, in plain sentences. Include how many people you're feeding, how many nights you want prepped meals, how much cooking time you can spare on the prep day, and what is off limits (allergies, dislikes, foods your kids won't eat). Mention any equipment you have, like a slow cooker or only one large pan.

When you send the message, the assistant usually replies by restating your rules or asking a follow-up question. That confirms it understood. If it doesn't restate anything, your message may have been too long; split it into two messages.

💬 Example: "We are a household of [number] people. Plan five dinners for [number] nights. We have about [number] hours to cook on Sunday. No peanuts, and nobody likes mushrooms. We only have one oven and a slow cooker."

You'll know it worked when the assistant repeats your constraints back to you or asks a clarifying question about them.

Step 2 — Ask for a five-day plan

Now ask for the meal plan itself. Good plans repeat ingredients across days, because that keeps the shopping list short and reduces waste. Ask the assistant to reuse ingredients on purpose and to vary the flavors so you don't eat the same dish five times.

A common result is a list of five dinners with a short note about which ingredients appear more than once. If the plan includes foods you already said you avoid, reply with a correction, and it will usually revise the whole plan rather than just one line.

💬 Example: "Using the rules above, make a five-night dinner plan. Reuse at least two ingredients across the week, keep the cooking to one pot or one oven tray per night, and label which items are cooked on prep day versus cooked fresh."

You'll know it worked when you see five named dinners and a note showing which ingredients repeat.

Step 3 — Turn the plan into one grocery list

This is where a multi-step prompt pays off. Because the assistant can see the plan you just approved in the same chat, you don't need to paste it again. Ask it to convert the meals into one combined list, with quantities added up across all five dinners, grouped by store section (produce, meat, dairy, dry goods, and so on).

Tell it to subtract anything you already have. This is important: the assistant can't check your pantry, so it will only do this correctly if you list what's on hand. Expect the quantities to be estimates. Treat them as a starting point, not a guarantee.

💬 Example: "Make one grocery list for all five dinners. Add up the quantities, group items by store section, and leave out [pantry item] and [pantry item] since I already have them."

You'll know it worked when the list is grouped by section and each item appears once, with a combined amount.

Step 4 — Save a reusable template

The real time-saver is keeping the instructions you just wrote, so next week you can paste them in rather than start over. Copy your household rules and your best prompt into a note, and name the note something clear like "Weekly meal prep template." Update only the parts that change, such as the number of nights or any new dislikes.

Many chat tools also let you save reusable instructions or start a project for recurring work, but menus vary by app and change over time. If you don't see such a feature, a plain note works just as well, so use that.

💬 Example: "Meal prep template: household of [number] people, [number] dinners, [number] hours to cook on Sunday, no [food you avoid]. Plan dinners, reuse ingredients, then give one grouped grocery list."

You'll know it worked when you have a saved note you can copy and paste into a new chat in under a minute.

Step 5 — Create a Sunday prep checklist

A list of groceries doesn't tell you what to do first. Ask the assistant for a prep order that fits the time you actually have. Good checklists put long-cooking items first (like a roast or a pot of grains), then chopping, then cooling and storing. Ask it to estimate how long each block takes, then compare that to your real hours.

Ask it to add storage notes too: which containers to use, and which cooked foods should go in the fridge versus the freezer. For specific food-safety timing, check your local food-safety guidance, because the assistant may be wrong or out of date.

💬 Example: "Create a prep-day checklist for about [number] hours. Put long-cooking items first, then chopping, then cooling and storing. Show the estimated time for each step, and list which items go in the fridge and which go in the freezer."

You'll know it worked when you get a numbered checklist with time estimates that add up to roughly the hours you have.

Step 6 — Check the answer before you shop

Never trust a plan without a quick review. Read through the list and ask yourself three questions: Does each dinner fit the cooking time? Do the quantities look right for your household size? Are any allergy or dislike items hiding inside a sauce or a packaged ingredient?

If something is off, reply with a specific correction instead of starting over. The assistant usually keeps the rest of the plan and adjusts only what you flagged, though it may also change other lines, so recheck the full list.

💬 Example: "Dinner three uses a whole bunch of cilantro for [number] people. Please cut that to one small bunch and update the grocery list to match."

You'll know it worked when the revised list reflects your correction and nothing you already approved has disappeared.

Step 7 — Move the final list where you shop

Copy the finished grocery list into your notes app or a plain text message to yourself. Plain text is the safest format, because it pastes cleanly into most shopping apps. If the copy looks messy with extra symbols, delete them by hand. Keep the section headings so the list stays organized in the store.

Finally, put the prep checklist and the template note in the same folder, so next week's planning starts from one place.

💬 Example: "Reformat the final grocery list as plain text with one item per line, keeping the store-section headings."

You'll know it worked when your list is ready to paste into a shopping app or read from your phone in the store.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the quantities blindly.** The assistant can't see your fridge, the store's stock, or package sizes. Fix this by reviewing amounts against what you actually buy, and by listing pantry items in Step 3.
- **Asking for everything in one giant message.** Long, tangled requests produce muddled plans. Fix this by working through the steps in order, one request at a time.
- **Skipping the check.** A plan can look polished and still include a food someone avoids. Fix this with the three questions in Step 6 before you shop.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Plan one week of dinners in about 30 minutes on a weekend, then reuse your saved template each week to make it faster.
- **For your business or work:** If you cook for a team, a small office, or a daycare, the same method works. Change the household rules to match the number of servings and the kitchen you have.
- **If you want to go further:** Ask the assistant to build your template as a series of questions it asks you each week, so you only answer what changed. Test it once before you rely on it.

One honest limit: the assistant can draft the plan and the list, but it can't check your pantry, read store shelves, or buy anything for you. You still do the final review and the shopping.

Try it now

Open a new chat and send the household-rules message from Step 1, filling in your own numbers. Then ask for just the five-dinner plan. That's a complete first run, and you'll have something to build on next week.

Create a soothing bedtime story routine with Alexa

7 steps · Read online

Imagine tucking your child into bed and simply saying, “Alexa, start bedtime story.” In just a few minutes, you can set up a gentle routine that Alexa will read aloud each night, complete with a soothing voice and soft background sounds. Once it’s saved, you can use it every evening with a single voice command, creating a lovely ritual for your family.

Before you start

- An **Amazon account** (free).
- The **Alexa app** installed on your phone or tablet (free).
- A **device with Alexa** (like an Echo Dot, Echo Show, or similar).
- Access to a **bedtime story skill or content** (many free options are available; some specific premium content may require a paid subscription like Audible or Amazon Music Unlimited).
- Roughly **10-15 minutes** to set up.

Step 1 — Open the Alexa app and find Routines

First, open the **Alexa app** on your phone or tablet. When it loads, you’ll typically see the home screen with various cards and information. Look at the bottom of the screen for a navigation bar with several icons. Tap the icon that looks like **three horizontal lines** or a **square 'More' button** in the bottom-right corner. This will open a menu. On the next screen, find and tap the word **Routines**. Routines are like your personal scripts for Alexa, telling her to perform a series of actions based on a trigger.

If it looks different: If you don't see "More" or three lines, look for a 'Settings' gear icon, or a menu icon that looks like nine dots or a hamburger menu. The goal is to find the main menu where 'Routines' is listed.

💬 Example: Tap `More` → `Routines`.

You'll know it worked when you see a screen titled "Routines" with a large "Create Routine" or "Add a Routine" button.

Step 2 — Create and name your routine

Now you're on the Routines screen, tap the **+ Create Routine** or **Add a Routine** button. The app will then present you with options to build your new routine. The first thing to do is give it a simple, memorable name. Look for a field labeled "Enter routine name" or "Routine name." This name is just for you to keep your routines organized.

If it looks different: The button might be a plus (+) icon in the top-right corner, or simply "New Routine." Tap it to begin.

Example: Type `Bedtime Story` into the name field.

You'll know it worked when your chosen name appears in the designated field, and you see options to set "When this happens" and "Add action."

Step 3 — Set the voice command (trigger)

Next, you need to tell Alexa what phrase you'll say to start this routine. Under the section labeled **When this happens**, tap the + or **Add** button. From the list of trigger options, tap **Voice**. A new screen will appear where you can type your preferred phrase. This phrase is your "voice trigger" – the specific command Alexa will listen for to activate your routine. Keep it simple and easy to remember for everyone who might use it.

If it looks different: Instead of "Voice," you might see an option like "Phrase" or "Custom command." Select that to type your phrase.

Example: Type `start bedtime story`.

You'll know it worked when your chosen phrase is displayed under "When this happens" on the routine creation screen.

Step 4 — Add the bedtime story action

Now it's time to add the actual story. Under the **Add action** section, tap the + or **Add** button. You'll see a list of actions Alexa can perform. Since we want a story, we'll choose a content-playing option. Tap on **Skills** or **Music & Audio**. If you choose Skills, you can search for a specific bedtime story skill (many are free). If you choose Music & Audio, you can type "bedtime story" and Alexa will find suitable content from your linked services or free options. Select your preferred story source.

If it looks different: Look for categories like "Play," "Entertainment," or "Listen" if "Skills" or "Music & Audio" aren't immediately visible.

Example: Tap `Skills` → search for `bedtime stories` → select a skill like `Kids Bedtime Stories` and tap `Add`.

You'll know it worked when the selected story skill or music command appears in the list under "Add action."

Step 5 — Customize Alexa's voice for the routine

You can give your bedtime story a calm, consistent voice. While still on the routine setup screen, scroll down and look for an option called **Alexa's Voice** (or sometimes "Speaking Style" or just "Voice"). Tap on this to see the available voices. Choose one that sounds soothing, like "Matthew" or "Emma," or another voice if your app offers more options. This setting ensures Alexa uses this particular voice for all the speaking actions within this routine.

If it looks different: The option might be labeled "Choose Alexa's voice" or "Voice Settings" within the routine.

- Example: Tap `Alexa's Voice` and choose `Matthew`.

You'll know it worked when the name of the voice you selected is displayed next to the "Alexa's Voice" option in the routine.

Step 6 — Add a calming background sound (optional)

To make the storytime even cosier, you can add a gentle background sound that plays after the story or simultaneously. Tap **Add action** again. This time, navigate to **Music & Audio** (or sometimes "Sleep Sounds" or "Nature Sounds"). Search for a calming sound like "rain sounds," "ocean waves," or "soft piano music." Select your desired sound and confirm. Remember that this will typically play *after* the story action in the routine unless you adjust the order.

If it looks different: Some background sounds might be listed directly under "Sleep Sounds" as a separate action type.

- Example: Tap `Music & Audio` → search for `rain sounds` → select a track and tap `Add`.

You'll know it worked when the background sound action appears below your story action in the routine's list of actions.

Step 7 — Save and test your routine

Once you've added all your desired actions and settings, it's time to save your routine. Look for the **Save** button, which is often found in the top-right corner of the screen. Tap it to finalise your new routine. After saving, the routine will appear in your list of active Alexa Routines. To test it, go to any Alexa-enabled device and speak the voice command you set up earlier.

If it looks different: The "Save" button might be a tick mark (✓) or a "Done" button. If Alexa doesn't respond when you test, double-check your trigger phrase for spelling or pronunciation in the Alexa app.

- Example: Say: `Alexa, start bedtime story`.

You'll know it worked when Alexa begins speaking the bedtime story in the voice you chose, potentially followed by the selected background sound.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Alexa doesn't respond when you say the trigger phrase. **Fix:** Go back into the Alexa app, find your "Bedtime Story" routine, and check the spelling of your trigger phrase under "When this happens." Ensure it's exactly what you're saying, and try speaking it slowly and clearly to your Alexa device.
- **Mistake:** Alexa plays the wrong story or just says "playing bedtime story" instead of reading one. **Fix:** The "Alexa Says" action is for Alexa to speak text, not to play content. Go back to your routine, delete the incorrect action, and add a new one by tapping "Add action" → "Skills" or "Music & Audio" to select a proper story skill or music.
- **Mistake:** The background music is too loud or not playing at all. **Fix:** If the sound isn't playing, ensure it's added as a separate "Music & Audio" action *after* your story. If it's too loud, you can add another action "Device Settings" → "Volume" to set a specific volume for your Alexa device as part of the routine.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can now start a calming storytime routine for your child with a single voice command, freeing up your hands and giving you a few extra minutes to get ready for bed yourself, or simply relax while your child enjoys a custom story.
- **For your business or work:** While this specific routine is personal, the ability to create custom, multi-step actions with a single command can be adapted for work tasks, like a "start my workday" routine that plays news, adjusts lights, and reads your calendar.
- **If you're just getting started:** This is an excellent way to turn your Alexa device into a helpful, customized assistant, making a daily task smoother without needing any complex technical skills.

Try it now

Open the Alexa app, go to Routines, and create a new routine named "Bedtime Story." Set the trigger phrase to "start bedtime story," add a "Skills" or "Music & Audio" action to play a bedtime story, choose a calm Alexa voice for the routine, and then save it. Say the phrase aloud to any Alexa device to test it out.

How to use Qwen Chat to plan a weekend road trip in the US without getting lost

7 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll have a complete weekend road-trip plan—routes, stops, times, and even backup ideas—built with Qwen Chat in about 20 minutes. No prior travel-planning experience needed.

Before you start

- A free Qwen Chat account (sign-up takes 2 minutes at chat.qwen.ai)
- Any device with a web browser (phone, tablet or computer)
- Rough idea of where you want to go (e.g., "Pacific Coast Highway" or "Blue Ridge Mountains")
- Total time: about 20 minutes

Step 1 — Open Qwen Chat and start a fresh chat

Open your browser and go to chat.qwen.ai. You'll see a clean white page with a big "Ask Qwen anything" box at the bottom. Tap or click inside that box to begin typing. A new chat window opens automatically. You'll know it worked when you see the blinking cursor ready for your first message. 💬 Example: `Hi`

Step 2 — Give Qwen the big picture of your trip

In the same message box type a short summary of what you want: where you're starting, where you're headed, how many days, and who's coming. This helps Qwen tailor every detail to your exact needs. You'll see Qwen reply with a friendly welcome and a quick question to confirm the basics. If the reply looks different on your screen, look for a small "Welcome" banner at the top of the chat. 💬 Example: `I want a weekend road trip from Portland to the Pacific Coast Highway with my partner, leaving Friday after work and returning Sunday evening. Can you plan every stop, time, and backup idea so we don't get lost?`

You'll know it worked when Qwen replies with a clear plan outline and asks for any must-see spots you already have in mind.

Step 3 — Ask Qwen to build the full day-by-day itinerary

Copy the itinerary request Qwen just gave you and paste it into the same chat, then add any personal must-sees. Qwen will now create a detailed hour-by-hour plan with driving times, lunch spots, scenic lookouts, and even fuel stops. On screen you'll see Qwen typing for about 10–

15 seconds, then a long list appears with every stop numbered and timed. If the list looks different (some Qwen versions show cards instead of text), look for a “Download” or “Copy” button near the top right of the reply. 💬 Example: `Here’s what I’d like to keep: the Twelve Apostles at sunset, a short rainforest walk at Maits Rest, and a seafood dinner in Apollo Bay. Please add those and any other must-sees, plus backup ideas if a stop is closed or crowded.`

You'll know it worked when you see a numbered list with Friday evening, Saturday full day, and Sunday morning—each with times, addresses, and backup notes.

Step 4 — Request turn-by-turn directions for each leg

Ask Qwen to turn every driving leg into simple turn-by-turn directions you can read aloud to a passenger or save to your phone. Qwen will list each leg separately with street names, kilometers, and estimated minutes. On your screen you’ll see a new bullet list under the itinerary. If the directions look too short, look for a “Show full route” link or button inside the reply. If it’s missing, just ask Qwen again. 💬 Example: `Please give me turn-by-turn directions for every driving leg, including street names and kilometres, so my partner can navigate while I drive.`

You'll know it worked when each leg shows something like “Drive south on Princes Hwy for 12 km, turn left onto Marengo Rd, continue 3 km to Apollo Bay Visitor Centre.”

Step 5 — Ask for backup ideas in case something changes

Tell Qwen you want backup stops for every main attraction in case the weather turns or a venue closes. Qwen will add a second set of options with shorter walks, indoor museums, or different viewpoints. On screen you’ll see the original list followed by a new “Backup ideas” section. If the section is missing, look for a “More suggestions” button or simply ask Qwen again. 💬 Example: `Add a backup plan for every main stop in case it’s raining or too crowded. Include indoor alternatives and shorter walks.`

You'll know it worked when you see a clear “Backup ideas” heading with 2–3 options for each main stop.

Step 6 — Request a printable or shareable summary

Ask Qwen to create a single clean summary you can save as a PDF, print, or send to your travel buddy. Qwen will combine the itinerary, directions, and backups into one easy-to-read page. On screen you’ll see a new message with a heading like “Your Weekend Road-Trip Plan – Ready to Save.” If the text is too long, look for a “Copy all” or “Download PDF” button at the bottom of

the reply. 💬 Example: `Please give me one clean summary I can save or print, with every stop, time, address, and backup idea in one place.`

You'll know it worked when you see a single block of text with a clear title and everything in order.

Step 7 — Double-check the plan with one final question

Ask Qwen to review the whole plan for anything you might have missed—toll roads, low-fuel areas, or time buffers. Qwen will point out any gaps and suggest tweaks. On screen you'll see a short checklist at the end of the chat. If the checklist is missing, simply ask Qwen again. 💬 Example: `Please review the entire plan for anything I might have missed—toll roads, fuel stops, or time buffers—and suggest any tweaks.`

You'll know it worked when you see a green checkmark list with no red flags.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Giving Qwen a vague request like "Plan a trip." **Fix:** Always include start, end, days, and who's coming so Qwen can tailor every detail.
- **Mistake:** Skipping the backup step and assuming everything will be open. **Fix:** Ask Qwen for backup ideas right after the main itinerary—rain or closure can ruin a perfect day.
- **Mistake:** Trusting the plan without checking the turn-by-turn directions. **Fix:** Always ask Qwen for street-by-street directions and save them to your phone before you leave.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Next time you're dreaming of a spontaneous weekend escape, open Qwen Chat, paste your rough idea, and in 20 minutes you'll have a complete, stress-free plan you can trust—no travel-agent fees, no last-minute scrambling.
- **For your business or work:** If you organize team off-sites or client retreats, use Qwen Chat to draft itineraries, directions, and backup plans overnight, so you can focus on the event itself instead of logistics.
- **If you're just getting started:** This is the easiest first move—open Qwen Chat, type a simple request, and watch Qwen build a full weekend plan for you. You'll feel instantly capable and ready for your next adventure.

Try it now

Open chat.qwen.ai, paste the example prompt from Step 2, and hit send. In under a minute you'll have a complete weekend road-trip plan you can trust.

Turn messy phone photos into a family album with Google Photos AI

7 steps · Read online

Imagine opening your phone and finding every photo of your kids, your partner, or your dog already gathered in one album — no endless scrolling, no guessing. Google Photos can group your pictures by the faces in them (Google calls this **Face Groups**), and a **live album** keeps adding new photos of the people you choose, all by itself.

Before you start

- A phone or tablet with the **Google Photos app** (Android or iPhone), signed in with your free Google account.
- Some family photos already in Google Photos.
- Face Groups isn't available in every country. If you can't find it, see Common mistakes below.
- Rough total time: **7–10 minutes**.

The button names below come from Google's own Google Photos Help for Android. On an iPhone they are the same or very close.

Step 1 — Open Google Photos and sign in

Find the **Google Photos** app — its icon is a pinwheel in red, yellow, green, and blue — and tap it. If the app asks you to sign in, use your Google account (the one you use for Gmail or YouTube). You'll know it worked when your photos appear in a grid.

💬 Example: Open Google Photos → sign in with your Google account → wait for your photos to load.

Step 2 — Make sure Face Groups is turned on

At the top, tap your **profile photo** or **initials**. Tap **Google Photos settings**, then **Privacy**, and turn **Face Groups** on. This is the setting that lets Google Photos group similar faces together. You'll know it worked when the Face Groups switch shows as on.

💬 Example: Profile photo → **Google Photos settings** → **Privacy** → **Face Groups**: on.

Step 3 — Find the people in your photos

At the bottom of the screen, tap **Collections**, then **People & pets**. You'll see the face groups Google Photos has made — each one is a small round picture of a face. If you've only just turned Face Groups on, the groups may not be ready yet; come back to this screen a little later. You'll know it worked when you see a row of faces under **People & pets**.

💬 Example: Tap **Collections** → **People & pets** → look through the faces.

Step 4 — Name the people you care about

Tap a face to open its group. At the top of the group, tap **Add a name**, then type a name or nickname — for example "Mom", "Liam", or "Grandpa Joe". Names only help you; they make the people easy to pick in the next step. Sometimes Google Photos shows you two groups and asks whether they are the same person. Tap **Same**, **Different**, or **Not sure**. If you give a second group a name you've already used, Google Photos asks if you want to merge the two face groups. You'll know it worked when the name appears under that face in **People & pets**.

💬 Example: Tap a face → **Add a name** → type `Dad` → confirm.

Step 5 — Create a live album that fills itself

Go back to the main screen. At the top right, tap **Add**, then **Album**. Tap **Select people & pets**. On each face group you want in the album — say Mom, Dad, and Liam — tap **Select**. At the top right, tap **Confirm**. This is a **live album**: from now on, new photos of the people you picked are added to it automatically. You can give it a title such as "Family 2025". You'll know it worked when the album opens and shows photos of the people you chose.

💬 Example: **Add** → **Album** → **Select people & pets** → tap **Select** on Mom, Dad, and Liam → **Confirm**.

Step 6 — Share the album with family

Open the album and tap **Share**. To get a link you can send anywhere, tap **Create link**. Paste it into a text message or an email. Google's help notes that anyone who has the link can view the album, so send it only to people you trust. You'll know it worked when you have a link ready to paste.

💬 Example: Open "Family 2025" → **Share** → **Create link** → paste the link into a message to Grandma.

Step 7 — Let the album keep itself up to date

Because it's a live album, you don't need to add new photos by hand. Every few weeks, open **Collections → People & pets** and use **Add a name** on any new faces you care about, so they are easy to find and pick next time. You'll know it worked when new photos of your family show up in the album without you adding them.

💬 Example: Take a few new photos of your kids → open "Family 2025" a day later → check that they've appeared.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** You can't find **People & pets**. **Fix:** Google lists three reasons: the feature isn't available in your region, Face Groups is turned off in settings (turn it on as in Step 2), or no face groups have been created yet (check back later).
- **Mistake:** A photo of someone else ended up in the album. **Fix:** Face Groups isn't perfect, and Google says so itself. Open the photo in the album and remove it from the album — it stays in your library.
- **Mistake:** The same person appears as two different faces. **Fix:** Give both groups the same name. Google Photos will ask whether you want to merge the face groups.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** No more scrolling through hundreds of photos to find pictures of your child's birthday or your last holiday. One album gathers every photo of your family and keeps growing on its own, ready to share with relatives.
- **For your business or work:** For team events or project photos, a shared album link beats a pile of email attachments. Only add people's faces to groups and albums with their permission.
- **If you're just getting started:** Name just one or two people first. Once you see the live album fill up, add the rest of the family.

Try it now

Open Google Photos, tap **Collections → People & pets**, and use **Add a name** on one face. Then tap **Add → Album → Select people & pets** to make your first live album — it takes about two minutes.

Organize your favorite recipes with Perplexity Q&A

7 steps · Read online

Imagine having every recipe you love—from Grandma's scones to your go-to curry—stored in one place you can search by ingredient, diet, or mood. With Perplexity's Q&A feature, you can turn your scattered notes into a living cookbook that answers your questions instantly. No apps, no logins, just one chat.

Before you start

- A **free Perplexity account** (sign up at perplexity.ai).
- A **device with a web browser** (phone, tablet, or computer).
- A list of 3–5 recipes you want to save (handwritten, photos, or links).
- **10 minutes** of focused time.

Step 1 — Create a new Perplexity space for your recipes

Open your browser and go to perplexity.ai. Sign in with your free account. On the left sidebar, look for a button like **"+ New Space"** (it might be under a "Spaces" heading or a plus icon). Tap it. A new blank space will open with a chat box at the bottom. This space will act like a private recipe folder. You'll know it worked when you see a clean, empty chat box and the space name at the top is editable.

Example: Type: `My Recipe Book`

Step 2 — Paste your first recipe into the chat

In the chat box, paste the full text of one recipe. Include the title, ingredients, and instructions. If your recipe is in a photo, describe it clearly in words. After you press Enter, Perplexity will show a summary card of the recipe at the top of the chat. It may also ask a follow-up question like "Would you like me to organize this?" You'll know it worked when you see the recipe summary appear above the chat and the assistant asks a helpful follow-up.

Example:

```
Pumpkin Soup
Ingredients: 1 kg pumpkin, 1 onion, 2 carrots, 400ml coconut milk, 1 tsp cumin
Instructions: Peel and chop veggies. Sauté onion. Add pumpkin, spices, and water.
Simmer 20 mins. Blend. Stir in coconut milk.
```

Step 3 — Ask Perplexity to store the recipe in your space

Below the recipe summary, type: “Save this as a recipe in My Recipe Book.” Perplexity will confirm by showing a message like “Added to your space: Pumpkin Soup.” Your space now contains a growing list of recipes. If you don’t see the confirmation, look for a small “Saved” badge or check the space sidebar. You'll know it worked when the recipe appears in the space sidebar or you see a “Saved” confirmation.

- Example: Save this as a recipe in My Recipe Book.

Step 4 — Ask Perplexity to find recipes by ingredient

In the same space, type a question like: “Show me all recipes with coconut milk.” Perplexity will scan your saved recipes and return a list with the matching ones highlighted. If you don’t see results, check that you used the exact ingredient name (e.g., “coconut milk” not “coconutcream”). You'll know it worked when you see a clean list of recipe titles with the matching ingredient in bold.

- Example: Show me all recipes with coconut milk.

Step 5 — Ask Perplexity to suggest meals based on what you have

Type: “What can I cook tonight with pumpkin and coconut milk?” Perplexity will analyze your saved recipes and suggest the Pumpkin Soup you added earlier. If the answer is off, rephrase with more detail: “Only recipes I’ve saved in My Recipe Book.” You'll know it worked when you see a relevant recipe suggestion with a clear reason why it fits.

- Example: What can I cook tonight with pumpkin and coconut milk?

Step 6 — Share your recipe space with a friend

At the top of your space, look for a button like **“Share”** or an icon that looks like a box with an arrow. Tap it and copy the share link. Send the link to a friend via message or email. They’ll open it in their browser and see your recipes without needing an account. If you don’t see a share button, look under a menu like “…” or “More.” You'll know it worked when your friend confirms they can view your recipes in their browser.

- Example: https://perplexity.ai/space/12345-my-recipe-book

Step 7 — Ask Perplexity to scale up your collection

Now that your space is set up, add more recipes the same way: paste the text, ask Perplexity to save it, and tag it with keywords like “vegan”, “quick”, or “weeknight”. Over time, your space becomes a smart cookbook that answers questions like “What’s a quick vegan dinner?” or “What uses leftover pumpkin?” You'll know it worked when you can ask natural questions and get accurate recipe suggestions from your growing collection.

💬 Example: What’s a quick vegan dinner I can make?

Common mistakes

- **Pasting messy text**: If the recipe summary looks wrong, clean up the pasted text and try again. Perplexity works best with clear, plain language.
- **Forgetting to save**: Always say “Save this as a recipe in My Recipe Book” after pasting. Without this step, your recipes won’t be searchable.
- **Using vague names**: Name your space something clear like “My Recipe Book” instead of “Stuff”. It helps Perplexity organize your recipes better.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life**: Keep your family’s favorite recipes in one place you can search by ingredient or diet. No more scrolling through old notebooks or photos—just ask Perplexity and get answers instantly.
- **For your business or work**: If you run a small cooking class or food blog, use a shared Perplexity space to organize recipes by theme or season. Clients can ask for meal ideas and get instant, accurate answers.
- **If you're just getting started**: Start with three recipes. Once you see how easy it is to search and share, add more over time. The key is consistency—small steps build a powerful cookbook.

Try it now

Open Perplexity in your browser, create a space called “My Recipe Book”, paste one recipe, and ask Perplexity to save it. You’ll have a living cookbook in under two minutes.

Build a Simple Weekly Meal Plan With Grok Based on What's in Your Fridge

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open Grok, list what's actually in your fridge, and ask for a 7-day dinner plan with a shopping list. You'll get dinner ideas matched to your real ingredients in one chat — no paid plan or cooking skill required.

By the end of this guide, you'll have a real 7-day dinner plan built around what's already sitting in your fridge, plus a shopping list for what you're missing. This is for anyone who keeps opening the fridge at 6pm and feeling stuck — no fancy equipment, just a free Grok account and about ten minutes.

One honest note up front: Grok can draft the plan and the list, but it can't go shopping for you, and it can't tell if your chicken is actually still good. That part is still on you.

Before you start

- A free Grok account (sign up through the Grok website or the X app — both work)
- Three minutes to peek inside your fridge, freezer, and pantry
- Optional: a notes app open so you can paste the final plan into it
- Total time: about 10 minutes, mostly for the food peek and saving

Step 1 — Open Grok and start a fresh chat

Open Grok on your phone or computer. On a computer, go to the Grok website and sign in. On a phone, open the Grok app — or open X and look for a small ⚡ icon somewhere in the menu. Once you're signed in, you'll see a chat box at the bottom of the screen with a placeholder like "Ask Grok anything." A fresh chat keeps the assistant focused on your meal plan instead of mixing it up with old conversations.

If you don't see a chat box right away, look for a button labeled "New chat" or a + icon in a corner. The Grok entry point inside X moves around as the app updates, so try the menu or the search bar if it's not where you expect.

💬 Example: type "Hi" to test the connection, or jump straight to Step 2 with your list ready.

You'll know it worked when you see an empty chat box and a blinking cursor, waiting for your first message.

Step 2 — Take quick stock of your fridge and pantry

Before opening Grok, spend two or three minutes looking through your fridge, freezer, and pantry. Write down what you actually have — not what you wish you had. Include basics like rice, pasta, canned beans, and any half-used vegetables. Note proteins too: chicken, eggs, tofu, ground meat, or fish. Spices and condiments matter as well, because they change what meals are possible.

Group items roughly by type — vegetables, proteins, grains, dairy, pantry staples — so the list is easy to scan. Also jot down how many people you're feeding. Grok uses the serving size to scale recipes up or down.

Example: "Fridge: 2 chicken breasts, half a head of broccoli, 4 eggs, a wedge of cheddar. Pantry: rice, canned chickpeas, soy sauce, olive oil, garlic. Freezer: frozen peas. Serving 2 adults."

You'll know it worked when you have a written list of 8–20 ingredients plus a serving size, ready to paste into the chat.

Step 3 — Paste your list and ask for a 7-day plan

Paste your ingredient list into the Grok chat box and add a clear request. Be specific about the timeframe, the number of meals, and any restrictions. Grok answers best when you spell out exactly what you want — for example, "dinners for 7 nights, no seafood, weeknight meals under 30 minutes, vegetarian on Fridays." More context means a closer first answer.

After you hit send, wait a few seconds. Grok usually replies with a day-by-day breakdown: meal name, short description, and a rough cooking method. The first answer is rarely perfect — that's normal, not a failure.

If you don't see a typed reply within 15 seconds, check your connection and try again. The chat often shows a small "thinking" indicator before the answer appears.

Example: "Here's what I have: [paste your list]. Build me a 7-day dinner plan for 2 adults. No seafood. Keep weeknight meals under 30 minutes. Use what I already have first, then suggest what to buy."

You'll know it worked when Grok returns a numbered list of seven meals, each tied to ingredients from your fridge.

Step 4 — Adjust the plan to your taste and schedule

Look over Grok's first answer. Anything you don't like? Speak up — that's the easiest part of using a chatbot. Reply in plain language and tell it what to swap. Maybe Tuesday's curry doesn't fit your weeknight energy. Maybe Saturday feels too involved for a relaxed weekend. Ask for replacements, and Grok will rewrite just those days.

This is also the moment to mention things you forgot: a picky eater, a slow cooker you want to use, or leftovers for lunch the next day. The more you iterate, the more the plan feels like yours rather than a generic template.

If a meal keeps coming back that you really don't want, say so directly. The chat remembers your earlier messages in the same conversation, so a clear "no mushrooms anywhere" once is usually enough.

💬 Example: "Swap Tuesday's curry for something quicker — under 20 minutes. Add a slow-cooker recipe for Sunday. And please skip mushrooms entirely; nobody here eats them."

You'll know it worked when the updated plan reflects your changes and you can imagine actually cooking each meal.

Step 5 — Ask Grok to build a shopping list of missing items

Once the plan feels right, ask Grok to compile the shopping list. Specifically, request only the items you don't already have — otherwise you'll end up buying things already sitting in your pantry. A good prompt names the servings and asks Grok to group the list by aisle or category, which makes the actual shopping trip faster.

Grok will usually return a checklist sorted into sections like produce, dairy, pantry, and frozen. Some answers even estimate quantities. If the list looks too long, ask it to shrink by reusing ingredients across two or three meals — that's both cheaper and faster to cook.

If you want a printable version, ask Grok to format it as a simple numbered list or a table — then copy and paste it into your notes app.

💬 Example: "Great. Now give me a shopping list of only what I'm missing, grouped by aisle (produce, dairy, pantry, frozen, meat). Quantities for 2 adults. Keep it under 25 items if you can."

You'll know it worked when you have a clean, grouped shopping list of just the items you don't already have at home.

Step 6 — Save the plan somewhere easy to find

Now save your meal plan and shopping list before the chat scrolls away. Open your phone's notes app, email, or any list tool you already use, and paste both lists in. Give the note a clear name like "Week of June 8 — Meal Plan" so you can find it next week.

If you're on a computer, you can print the shopping list straight from the browser. Most grocery apps also let you email yourself a list — copy from Grok, paste into the app, and check items off

as you walk the aisles.

One more thing worth doing now: skim the plan once more for anything you actually dislike — easier to swap a meal now than at 6pm on a Wednesday. If you want to come back to this conversation later, look for a way to bookmark or pin it in the Grok interface (if available), so you can ask for a new plan in seconds next week.

💬 Example: "OK, I'm ready to save this. Can you format the final 7-day plan and the shopping list as plain text I can copy into my notes app?"

You'll know it worked when both lists are saved in your notes app.

Common mistakes

- **Asking Grok to invent ingredients you don't have.** If you say "what can I make?" without listing what's actually in your fridge, you'll get random recipes — not a plan that uses your food. Fix: always paste your real inventory first, then ask for ideas.
- **Accepting the first plan without iterating.** Grok's first answer is a draft, not a final menu. If a meal feels wrong, just say so. Fix: reply with swaps ("Tuesday's too spicy — give me something milder") until the plan matches your week.
- **Forgetting to mention dietary needs or picky eaters.** The assistant can only work with what you tell it. Fix: spell out allergies, vegetarians in the household, and "no fish" rules at the start, so the plan fits your family from the first reply.
- **Saving the chat but losing the shopping list.** It's easy to skim past the second reply. Fix: ask for the shopping list as a separate, grouped message and paste it into your notes app or grocery list right away.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You spend less time staring at the fridge and less money on food that quietly goes bad. A good plan turns "what's for dinner?" from a daily decision into a quick glance at your phone.
- **For your work:** If you cook for a team, a book club, or a shared household, the same workflow scales — just bump the servings in your prompt and ask for batch-cooking tips. Grok can suggest what to make ahead on Sunday for the rest of the week.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't aim for perfection on your first try. Make a list, send a quick prompt, and accept a rough plan you can fix later. Each week gets easier, and your fridge will start feeling a lot less random.

Try it now

Open your fridge right now, take a quick mental photo of what's inside, and paste this into Grok:

"Here's what's in my fridge and pantry: [your list]. Make me a 3-day dinner plan for [number] people. Use what I have first. No [food you dislike]."

See what comes back. If it sparks an idea, you've just made your week easier in under two minutes.

Plan a Budget-Friendly City Vacation in One Afternoon

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can use any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, or Le Chat — to draft a realistic day-by-day city plan that fits a budget you set, in roughly an hour. The AI can't book flights, can't see today's prices, and can't know last-minute closures, so you'll confirm the practical details yourself before you go.

You don't need a travel agent, a giant spreadsheet, or three weekends of research. One afternoon with an AI assistant, a notebook (digital or paper), and a rough idea of where you want to go is enough to walk away with a plan you can actually use. This guide walks you through it step by step, with prompts you can copy and paste as you go.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant** — any one will do: ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Le Chat, or another you already use. A free plan works fine; a paid plan just gives longer answers. **Rough total time:** about 60–90 minutes, including the back-and-forth.
- **Two rough numbers** — your total budget (all-in, including flights) and the number of days you have. Ballpark is fine; you'll tighten them as you go.
- **One open notes app** — Google Docs, Notes, or a notebook, so you can save the good parts of each answer as you draft.

Step 1 — Tell the AI where, when, and how much

Open your AI assistant in a browser or app and start a fresh chat. You'll see a message box at the bottom of the screen, usually with a placeholder like "Message ChatGPT" or "Ask Gemini". If you don't see a blank chat, look for a **"New chat"** or + button first — you want a clean conversation so the AI doesn't mix your trip with old questions. In that box, type a clear one-paragraph brief: destination, number of days, month or season, who is traveling, and your total budget. Be specific about the kind of trip you want — food, walking, museums, neighborhoods, kid-friendly, quiet — because the first draft depends on it.

Example: *"I want to spend 4 days in Lisbon in mid-October. Just me, no car. My total budget including flights from the US East Coast is $1,800. I like walking, local food, neighborhoods, and one or two paid museums. I don't love big crowds. Give me a first-pass plan."*

You'll know it worked when you get back a clear day-by-day outline with morning, afternoon, and evening blocks, plus a short budget breakdown.

Step 2 — Ask for a money breakdown you can actually trust

Generic answers like "you can do Lisbon for $50 a day" are often too optimistic. In the same chat, reply and ask the AI to break the budget into categories: lodging, food, local transport, attractions, and a small "buffer" for surprises. Then ask which two categories usually eat most of the budget, and which is the easiest to cut without ruining the trip. If the assistant forgets the buffer, push it to add one — that single line is what keeps a budget plan from collapsing on day two.

Example: *"Thanks. Now break the $1,800 into lodging, food, transport within the city, attractions, and a buffer. Which two categories usually eat most of the budget for a 4-day solo trip, and which is the easiest to cut without ruining the trip?"*

You'll know it worked when the AI gives you specific categories with rough shares (for example: lodging 40%, food 30%) and names a clear "save here" lever — like staying just outside the center, eating lunch as the main meal, or using a city tourist card.

Step 3 — Build the day-by-day plan around free and cheap anchors

Now ask the AI to rebuild each day using mostly free or cheap anchors: public parks, walking neighborhoods, viewpoint walks, free museum days, markets, churches, street art, and self-guided routes. Tell it to mix in one paid "anchor" per day (a museum, a boat ride, a cooking class) and to group nearby stops so you don't waste hours on transport. If the first reply is just a list of sights, push back and ask for a route, not a list — that's the difference between a plan and a brochure.

Example: *"Rebuild the 4 days using mostly free or cheap anchors — parks, walking streets, viewpoints, free museum hours, markets. Put one paid anchor per day, and group nearby things together so I'm not crossing the city for every stop. Flag anything that's usually very crowded."*

You'll know it worked when each day reads like a real route, not a list. You should be able to picture yourself walking from one stop to the next, with a coffee break and a meal built in.

Step 4 — Pressure-test the plan against your real life

A pretty plan on paper is not the same as a plan you'll actually do. In the same chat, copy the day-by-day plan back in and ask the assistant to challenge it. Specifically: how much walking is that, do I need to pre-book anything, and what should I do if it rains? This is where the AI is most useful as a calm second opinion, not as a source of fresh facts. If the assistant hedges ("it depends..."), ask for a worst-case number — that gets you a real answer.

Example: *"Here's the Day 2 plan you gave me: Alfama walking tour → Sé cathedral → lunch in Graça → National Tile Museum → sunset at Miradouro da Senhora do Monte → dinner in Bairro Alto. Push back on this: how much walking is that, do I need to book the museum, and what's a good rainy-day swap?"*

You'll know it worked when you get honest pushback — for example, "this is 8–10 km on hills, you'll be tired by evening" or "yes, book the Tile Museum, lines can be long." Treat those notes as a starting point, then sanity-check the critical ones with a quick search.

Step 5 — Lock in the food and the small print

The difference between a budget trip and a stressful one usually lives in two places: food, and the small daily decisions. Ask the AI for a short list of typical local dishes at different price points (a cheap street-food version and a sit-down version for each), and for a "don't do this" list — tourist-trap areas to avoid, common scams, and transport passes worth buying versus ones to skip. Keep the food list short and memorable; you only need 5–8 dishes to feel like you ate the city, not 50.

Example: *"Give me a short list of Lisbon dishes with a 'cheap-eats version' and a 'sit-down version' for each. Then give me 5 'don't do this' warnings — the kind of thing a first-timer always falls for, like taxi scams, tourist-menu restaurants, or transport passes that don't pay off for 4 days."*

You'll know it worked when you have a small, memorable food list and 4–5 specific "watch out for" notes you can actually remember. These two things alone save most budget travelers the most money.

Step 6 — Save it as one clean page and share it

Finally, ask the AI to compress the whole plan into a single plain-text page you can copy into your notes app or print: the budget breakdown, the day-by-day plan, the food list, the warnings, and a short packing note. Keep it under one screen if you can. Then, if you're traveling with someone, share it as a doc so they can mark what they actually want to do. The skill here is editing — almost no first draft survives being copied into a real trip without one pass of cutting.

Example: *"Now compress everything we discussed into one tight page: budget shares, 4-day plan, food list, top 5 warnings, and a 5-line packing note for October weather. Keep it tight — I want to fit this on one screen on my phone."*

You'll know it worked when you can scroll the whole plan in under a minute, and a friend reading it cold understands your trip without you having to explain it.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the first plan as final.** The first draft is a starting point, not the answer. Always do one round of "push back on this" — it catches the unrealistic walking days and the missing reservations.
- **Skipping the buffer line.** A budget without a 10–15% buffer will not survive contact with reality. Add it before you start booking, not after the first surprise.
- **Asking the AI about current prices or openings.** AI assistants don't reliably know today's hotel rates, flight prices, or whether a small museum is closed for renovation. Confirm anything money- or time-sensitive on the official site or a recent review.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The same one-afternoon method works for a long weekend, a family visit, or any trip where you have a budget and a vague idea and need a workable plan by tonight.
- **For your business or work:** If you ever plan client visits, team offsites, or conference travel on a per-diem, the "brief → money breakdown → day plan → pressure-test → compress" pattern is how a good assistant plans anything, and you can reuse it for non-travel projects too.
- **If you're just getting started:** The single biggest upgrade is Step 4 — asking the AI to challenge its own plan. Most beginners stop at Step 1 and assume a pretty plan is a good plan. It usually isn't.

Try it now

Pick one city you've been curious about, open any AI assistant, and paste this: *"I want to spend 3 days in [city] in [month]. My budget is [$X] all-in. I like [2 things you like]. Build me a first-pass day-by-day plan with mostly free or cheap activities."* Spend the next 15 minutes reacting to what you get — that back-and-forth is the whole skill.

Plan a Weekend Trip From a One-Line Idea With Cohere

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** A single sentence like "weekend in Portland in October" is enough for Cohere to draft a day-by-day itinerary — but it will invent place names if you let it, so prime it with a short trip-planner instruction first, then tighten the plan one change at a time.

You already know how to send a message in Cohere Chat. This guide teaches a workflow you'll reuse every time you plan a trip: a one-time setup step, a structured first ask, and a series of small follow-ups that tighten the plan into something you can actually use on the day. By the end, you'll have a printable weekend outline and a reusable prompt you can paste into any future trip chat.

Before you start

- A Cohere account and the chat interface (web or app) you're already using.
- One rough idea of where you want to go and when — even "fall weekend, somewhere coastal" is enough.
- About 15 minutes the first time, around five minutes for future trips once you have the reusable prompt saved.

Step 1 — Open a new chat and set a trip-planner preamble

Start a fresh conversation so old context doesn't bleed in. Before you type your actual request, look at the top of the chat — there's usually a small field or a collapsible panel for **custom instructions** or a **system message** (sometimes labeled "Persona," or hidden behind a settings icon). Paste a short, plain-English brief: who you are, how detailed you want the answer, and any hard limits. This one-time setup makes every future prompt land better because the model already knows the shape you want. Example: *"You are a practical trip planner. I travel with one other adult, no kids. We like walking, local food, and one museum or landmark per trip max. Avoid luxury recommendations. Keep each day to three time blocks: morning, afternoon, evening. Never invent specific restaurant names — describe the cuisine and neighborhood instead."* You'll know it worked when the next reply already feels structured — it begins with a clear "Day 1 / Day 2" layout rather than a wall of suggestions. If it looks different on your device: if there's no obvious system-prompt field, paste the brief as the very first line of your message instead, prefixed with "Instructions for this chat:" — the effect is similar, just less convenient for reuse.

Step 2 — Send your one-line trip idea as a structured ask

Now type your vague idea, but wrap it in a request for a specific shape. A bare "weekend in Portland in October" is too open — Cohere will pick a structure for you, and you may not like it. So tell it what shape you want: how many days, what time blocks, what each block should contain. This is the difference between "give me ideas" and "give me a Saturday morning plan with a coffee spot." Example: *"Weekend trip idea: Portland, Oregon, second weekend of October, two adults, arriving Friday evening, leaving Sunday afternoon. Build a day-by-day plan in three time blocks per day (morning, afternoon, evening). For each block, give: one main activity, one place to eat (describe the cuisine and neighborhood, don't invent names), and a backup if it rains."* You'll know it worked when the reply comes back split into clearly labeled days and blocks — not a single paragraph of suggestions. If it looks different on your device: some Cohere views collapse long replies; if you only see the first half, look for a "Show more" or down-arrow at the bottom of the reply.

Step 3 — Push the answer toward your actual style

The first draft is rarely the one you'd actually use — it's a starting point. Read it once, then ask for one specific change. The most useful follow-ups are about *style*, not content: shorter walks, later mornings, more indoor options, less touristy. Asking for one thing at a time keeps the model from rewriting the whole plan and accidentally undoing the parts you liked. Example: *"Looks good overall, but tighten this: replace any block that requires a car with a public-transit option, and move any suggestion that starts before 9 a.m. to 10 a.m. or later. Keep everything else the same."* You'll know it worked when the reply keeps the same structure but only the blocks you asked about actually changed — not the whole plan. If it looks different on your device: if Cohere offers a thumbs-up/down or a "regenerate" button next to the reply, don't use regenerate here — that gives you a brand-new plan. Instead, send your tweak as a new message in the same chat so the previous version stays visible above it.

Step 4 — Add a rain backup for one specific slot

Weekend plans live or die by their backup. Pick the *single* most weather-dependent block — usually an outdoor afternoon — and ask for a swap. Naming one slot (not "the whole weekend") keeps the rest of your plan intact and gives you a clean A/B choice for the morning of the trip. Example: *"For Sunday afternoon only, give me a backup plan that works if it rains: an indoor activity, a nearby warm place for lunch, and a coffee stop I can walk to between them. Keep Saturday exactly as it is."* You'll know it worked when you see one new afternoon block with three labeled items, and Saturday's plan is unchanged above it. If it looks different on your device: if Cohere rewrites the whole plan instead of just the one slot, your message probably sounded too general ("give me rain backups") — rephrase to name the day and time block, like "For Sunday afternoon only…"

Step 5 — Ask for a one-screen summary you can actually use on your phone

Long replies are great for thinking; they're bad for using on the go. Ask Cohere to compress the whole plan into a single tight screen — short bullet lines, no descriptions, no explanations. This becomes the version you screenshot or paste into your notes app. 💬 Example: *"Now compress the whole plan — both days plus the Sunday rain backup — into a one-screen version I can read on my phone. Each item is one short line. No descriptions, no flowery language. Order: Friday evening, Saturday morning/afternoon/evening, Sunday morning/afternoon, Sunday rain backup."* You'll know it worked when the reply fits in roughly 12–18 short lines and reads like a checklist, not an essay. If it looks different on your device: if the summary comes back too long, send a follow-up like "Cut that in half — keep only the place and the time."

Step 6 — Move the plan out of the chat

A trip plan in a chat window is a plan you'll forget the moment you close the laptop. Send the one-screen summary out into a tool you actually open every day — your phone's notes app, a shared doc, or a calendar entry. This step takes 30 seconds and is the difference between a plan you read once and a plan you actually follow. 💬 Example: *"Now write me a copy-paste version of the one-screen summary that I can paste into Apple Notes or Google Keep. Use plain text, no markdown bold, one item per line, with a blank line between days."* You'll know it worked when the reply is plain text you can select, copy, and paste into any notes app without reformatting. If it looks different on your device: if Cohere still outputs markdown (bold headers, dashes), paste it into your notes app first, then strip the symbols manually — usually a 20-second job.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for "the best" anything.** Cohere will confidently invent names. Always ask it to *describe* the cuisine and neighborhood instead — then look up real places yourself on a maps app or review site.
- **Regenerating when you meant to tweak.** The regenerate button (or any equivalent) throws away your working plan. Use it only when the whole direction is wrong, never to fix one line.
- **Trying to make one prompt do everything.** A single huge message gets a generic reply. Better: one structured ask, then a series of small follow-ups. Each follow-up is a small commitment you can keep or throw away.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** any time you face a vague-to-specific task — a birthday plan, a moving-day checklist, a guest's weekend visit — the same workflow works: short

preamble, one structured ask, one tweak at a time, then a one-screen summary.

- **For your business or work:** the pattern translates directly to any project with a known shape and a few preferences — meeting agendas, conference prep, onboarding checklists. Set the preamble once for the project, then iterate.
- **If you want to go further:** next time, before sending your trip idea, paste in a small block of *your own* notes — a list of places a friend recommended, or three things you already booked — and ask Cohere to fit its suggestions around them. It gets dramatically more useful when you give it something real to anchor against.

Try it now

Open Cohere and start a new chat. Type one sentence — your real, vague idea for a weekend, even if it's just "somewhere warm in February." Then paste the Step 1 preamble above it, followed by the Step 2 prompt structure with your destination filled in. Two minutes, and you'll have a draft you can react to.

Use ChatGPT to Plan a Road Trip with Stops, Fuel Breaks, and Drive Time

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Give ChatGPT your start, destination, dates, and a daily driving cap, and it drafts a day-by-day plan with stops, fuel breaks, and sights. Double-check distances and closures yourself — it has no live traffic or gas data, and sometimes invents places that don't exist.

You know that moment when you're staring at a map, scrolling between two pins, wondering where to stop for lunch? That's exactly the kind of question ChatGPT handles well. You give it the boring facts and it gives you back a plan you can edit and actually drive.

Before you start

- A free ChatGPT account works. Paid plans unlock the newest, fastest models — check the official pricing page for current tiers.
- A phone or computer with the ChatGPT app, or any browser pointed at the official site.
- About 20–30 minutes, plus a notes app on your phone for the final plan (Apple Notes, Google Keep, or Notion all work).
- Know four things before you begin: starting city, final destination, travel dates, and roughly how many hours you want to drive each day.

Step 1 — Open ChatGPT and describe your trip in one paragraph

On a computer, open chatgpt.com in your browser and sign in. On a phone, open the ChatGPT app. If this is your first time, you land on a blank screen with a message field at the very bottom of the page — that's where you type. If you see an old conversation instead, look for a **New Chat** button (a pencil ✏️ or a square with a plus sign) at the top of the screen and tap it to start fresh. Type one short paragraph covering who's traveling, where you're starting, where you're going, and your dates. A few sentences is plenty, because ChatGPT works better with concrete details than vague ones. 💬 Example: "My partner and I are driving from Portland, Oregon to San Francisco, California on June 12, leaving around 8am. We like small towns, good coffee, and short hikes. We want to drive no more than 6 hours a day." You'll know it worked when your paragraph appears in the chat and a "typing…" indicator shows up below it.

Step 2 — Ask for a day-by-day itinerary with drive times

Once ChatGPT replies, type a follow-up asking it to break the trip into days, with the exact driving time for each leg and the suggested overnight stop. A new chat bubble appears below

your question, and within a few seconds ChatGPT starts typing a numbered day-by-day plan. Each day should show roughly how many hours you'll spend driving, where you'll sleep that night, and a one-line reason for the stop. 💬 Example: "Great. Now please give me a day-by-day plan. For each day, tell me the start city, the end city, total driving hours, and one sentence on why that stop is worth it." If the first reply is too general — say, just listing famous cities without hours — reply with "Please add driving hours for each day and the rough total mileage." ChatGPT remembers the conversation, so it rewrites the plan with that detail included. You'll know it worked when each day in the plan has a clear start, end, and a number of hours in the car.

Step 3 — Ask for fuel stops and meal breaks

With the skeleton in place, ask ChatGPT to mark fuel stops and rest breaks along each driving day. Type a short message asking for fuel stations roughly every 3–4 hours, plus one real meal stop per day. The chat updates in place, so the fuel plan lives right below the day-by-day driving plan you already have. 💬 Example: "Add a fuel stop about every 3 hours of driving, and one proper meal stop per day. Just give me the town or exit name and roughly when in the day I'd hit it." If your car is electric or your range is shorter, say so in a follow-up — for example, "My EV gets about 250 miles per charge, so plan charging stops around that." ChatGPT will adjust the plan in place. You'll know it worked when each driving day now lists one or two fuel stops and a meal break, with rough timing.

Step 4 — Ask for one or two things to see at each stop

Type a short follow-up asking for one or two small, specific things to see or do at each overnight stop — nothing fancy, just enough to make the drive feel like a trip. ChatGPT adds a "things to do" line under each day in the same chat, mixing one outdoor stop, one food pick, and one small museum or viewpoint where it makes sense. 💬 Example: "For each overnight stop, suggest one outdoor thing, one local food place, and one quick museum or viewpoint. Keep it short — we're not trying to cram the whole trip in." If a suggestion feels off — maybe it's closed, far from your route, or you've already been there — just reply "Skip the lighthouse one, give me a different outdoor stop" and ChatGPT will swap it out. You don't need to start over. You'll know it worked when each day has a small "things to do" line that fits the time you actually have.

Step 5 — Ask ChatGPT to spot problems with your plan

This is the step most people skip, and it's the one that saves the most headaches. Type a short message asking ChatGPT to act like a skeptical road-trip reviewer and poke holes in your plan. ChatGPT rewrites its previous answer with a "Things to double-check" section at the bottom, flagging things like long stretches with no fuel, late-evening arrivals in quiet towns, or driving legs that are clearly too long. Treat this as a free second opinion. 💬 Example: "Now read the

plan back to me like a skeptical friend. What looks too rushed? Which day has the longest stretch between fuel stops? Anything I should double-check before I leave?" If it doesn't flag anything, the plan isn't necessarily perfect — it just means nothing obvious jumped out. Always verify highway exit numbers, current fuel prices, and road closures with your map app before you drive. You'll know it worked when the plan ends with a short "Things to double-check" section you didn't have before.

Step 6 — Save the final plan to your phone or notes

Type one last short message asking ChatGPT to combine the whole trip into a clean, numbered list you can paste into your notes app. ChatGPT responds with a tidy plain-text version: Day 1, Day 2, each day on its own short block, fuel stops inline, things to do in a few words. Copy it with the **Copy** button at the top of the message, then paste into Apple Notes, Google Keep, Notion, or even a plain email to yourself. Now the plan lives somewhere you can read at a gas station without an internet connection. Example: "Now condense the whole trip into a clean numbered list I can paste into my notes app. Keep fuel stops inline with each day. Don't add anything new." If your plan changes mid-trip — a road closes, you want to stay an extra night — come back to this same chat and ask ChatGPT to rebuild just that day. It still has the full conversation in memory. You'll know it worked when you have a clean, copyable list on your phone that doesn't depend on ChatGPT being open.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting every name without checking.** ChatGPT sometimes invents a town, café, or gas station that doesn't exist. Before you drive anywhere new, paste the name into a search engine or your map app and confirm it's real and still open.
- **Forgetting that ChatGPT has no live data.** It can't see today's gas prices, current road closures, or weather. Use it for the shape of the trip, then use a real-time map and weather app for the day-of details.
- **Asking for too much in one giant prompt.** A 600-word question usually gets a vague answer. Break the planning into the six steps above — the conversation builds a better plan than any single mega-message could.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The same pattern works for any multi-stop day — a city break, a weekend of errands across town, a move between two apartments. Tell it the start, the end, the time you have, and ask for one chunk at a time.
- **For your business or work:** If you drive for work — delivery, sales calls, field service — paste tomorrow's address list into ChatGPT and ask it to group stops into the most efficient

route, with fuel and meal breaks folded in. It's a quick first draft before you load the addresses into a real route planner.

- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to plan a half-day drive you already know well, just to see how ChatGPT structures a route. You'll learn what to ask for, what to ignore, and how to push back when an answer feels off.

Try it now

Open ChatGPT and paste this: "I'm driving from [your city] to [a town 2–3 hours away] this Saturday, leaving at 9am. Give me a one-day plan with total driving hours, one fuel stop, one lunch stop, and one thing to see along the way." Read the reply, change one detail ("actually make the lunch stop a town with a bakery"), and notice how fast it rewrites. That's the muscle you want before planning the big trip.

How to scale a family recipe up or down for any number of guests

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Multiplying ingredients by a single number is the easy part — but cooking time, pan size, and a few bold flavors (like salt and baking powder) don't scale the same way. Here's how to scale a recipe without ruining it.

Every family recipe was written for one number of people, but most of us cook for crowds that refuse to stay that size. The good news: the ingredient math is the smallest part of the job. The bigger part is knowing *what doesn't' scale and adjusting for it on purpose.*

Before you start

- A printed or saved copy of the recipe you want to scale (look at the original serving size first).
- A calculator — the one on your phone works perfectly.
- Measuring cups and spoons; a kitchen scale is a nice extra if you have one.
- A pen or note app to jot down your multiplier and any tweaks you make.
- About **30 minutes** for the math, scaling, and the first round of cooking.

Step 1 — Find your scaling factor

Every later step depends on this one number, so get it right first. The math is simple: divide the number of people you want to feed by the number the recipe was originally written for. That decimal is your **scaling factor** — your "multiplier" — and you'll use it again and again. Think of it as the single dial that turns the whole recipe up or down.

For example, a recipe that feeds 6 is being stretched to 14 guests: 14 ÷ 6 = 2.33. Write that number somewhere visible — top of the recipe page, on a sticky note, or in your phone. **If your recipe doesn't list a serving size,** count what it's "meant to feed" — chicken for 4 means 4 portions of protein — and round your factor **up** rather than down. Leftovers beat running out every time.

💬 Example: original serves 6, you need 14 → factor = **2.33**; original serves 8, you need 4 → factor = **0.5**.

You'll know it worked when you have one decimal number that you can call out (or whisper) every time you measure an ingredient.

Step 2 — Multiply every dry, fatty, and bulk ingredient

Now that you have your factor, scale almost everything in the recipe: flour, sugar, rice, pasta, chopped vegetables, oil, and butter. Multiplying by 2.33 means **1 cup becomes 2.33 cups** — that is, just over 2¼ cups. Don't try to round too early; the decimals will wash out once everything goes in the pan. This is where most of the "volume" of your scaled dish comes from.

Example: 1 cup flour × 2.33 = about 2¼ cups; 2 tbsp butter × 1.5 = 3 tbsp.

If your calculator dies or you lose track, that's fine — for most spices and bulk ingredients, being within 10% of the math is close enough. The flavor of these ingredients scales reliably because they're part of the structure, not the seasoning.

You'll know it worked when you have a complete pile of measured ingredients, each one adjusted to your new guest count, ready to mix or cook.

Step 3 — Treat salt, leavening, and bold spices more gently

Here's the first place the math breaks down. **Salt, baking soda, baking powder, yeast, dried chili, and raw garlic** are flavor amplifiers, not bulk — they get loud fast when concentrated. Multiplying them by the full factor usually makes a scaled-up dish taste harsh, bitter, or chemical. The fix: multiply them by about **75–90%** of your factor instead. If your factor is 2.33, scale salt by 2, not 2.33. This single step is what separates a "fine" scaled recipe from one that genuinely tastes right.

Example: 1 tsp salt in the original × factor 2.33 (full math) would be ~2.33 tsp; gentler multiplier 2 → about 2 tsp is the right target.

If you're scaling DOWN, do the opposite: don't cut these ingredients by the full math ratio, or the dish goes flat. Use about 70% of the calculated amount, then taste at the end and add more if needed.

You'll know it worked when the seasoning in your scaled dish tastes similar to the original — not saltier, not duller, just right.

Step 4 — Pick a pan that fits the new volume

This is the step most home cooks forget, and it's where most scaled-up failures come from. Your recipe was designed for a specific pan shape and depth, and switching serving size without changing the pan leads to raw middles and burnt edges. The rule of thumb: aim for roughly the **same depth of food** in the pan as the original recipe. A cake for 6 in an 8-inch round is about 2 inches deep; when you scale up for 12, a 9×13-inch rectangular pan gets you there instead of trying to fit it all in a too-small round.

💬 Example: original 9×13 pan for 8 servings → 16 servings → use **two** 9×13 pans, or one large roasting pan.

If you don't have a bigger pan, use two of the original size side by side — that's the safest backup. Cooking two smaller dishes is almost always better than cramming everything into one overflowing pan.

You'll know it worked when the food fills the pan to about the same depth as the original recipe, not piled higher or sitting in a too-thick layer.

Step 5 — Adjust cooking time and oven temperature carefully

Time doesn't scale with servings — heat has to travel through the food, and bigger batches just take longer to heat **all the way through**. Keep the oven temperature the same as the recipe says, but start checking for doneness 10–15 minutes **before** the original cooking time. Then add cooking time in small chunks. A doubled casserole might take about 1.3× longer, not 2× longer. A doubled cake may need only 5–10 extra minutes, not double.

💬 Example: original bake time = 45 min → start checking at **30 min**, then every 5 min after, using a toothpick or thermometer.

If the dish is very thick or dense (lasagna, bread, dense meat loaf), expect closer to a 1.5× time increase. **For thin or mostly-liquid dishes** (soup, custard, sauce), the time barely changes — just rely on the visual cues the original recipe gave you.

You'll know it worked when the food is fully cooked inside — not just colored on the outside — at a time that's "a bit longer than the original," not doubled.

Step 6 — Taste, adjust, and save your notes for next time

A scaled family recipe is a working document, not a finished product. The first scaled batch is always a learning experience, and that's the point. When the dish is done, taste it and write down what you'd change next time — more salt, less bake time, a bigger pan. Most home cooks find that three rounds in is when a scaled recipe finally feels "dialed in" for any crowd.

💬 Example: "Scaled 2× for Thanksgiving. Next time: bigger pan, 10 min less in oven, +½ tsp salt."

If the first attempt misses the mark, that's not a failure — it's data. Salt too low? Add a pinch at the table. Too dry? Spoon a little sauce on. The next batch will be better because of this one.

You'll know it worked when you have a working scaling factor and a few small tweaks written down for next time — and a dish your guests are still talking about.

Common mistakes

- **Doubling salt and baking powder along with everything else.** The dish turns harsh, bitter, or flat. Fix: scale these by 75–90% of your factor, then taste.
- **Using the same pan and hoping for the best.** A too-full pan cooks unevenly — burnt edges, raw middle. Fix: aim for the same depth of food as the original, or split into two pans.
- **Multiplying the cook time** by the same factor. Time doesn't scale that way. Fix: keep the oven temperature, start checking 10–15 minutes early, and rely on visual cues or a thermometer instead of the clock.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** you can host impromptu dinners, potlucks, or holiday gatherings without panic-buying takeout as backup. Scaling becomes a small mental habit, not a major project.
- **For family recipes and gatherings:** the recipe stays *yours* forever — you just adjust it to the crowd. Grandma's cookie recipe works for 4, 14, or 40 once you know the trick.
- **If you're just getting started:** don't try to tackle a wedding cake on day one. Pick one reliable family recipe and try multiplying it by 1.5× this week. The math gets easier with practice, and so does the intuition.

Try it now

Open the calculator app on your phone, choose a recipe you trust (something simple is best — cookies, soup, or a one-pan dinner), and work out the factor you need for next week's meals. Multiply the dry ingredients and salt by hand, just to feel how short the math actually is. The ingredient list is the easy half — and now you know exactly where the tricky half lives.

How to create a custom bedtime story starring your child with any AI

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Any modern AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or others — can write a custom bedtime story starring your child in about five minutes. You type a few clear sentences about who to include and what should happen, and the assistant drafts a story you can read aloud or save.

In the next few minutes, you'll have a story where your kid is the main character, their goldfish is the sidekick, and the adventure happens in their favorite park — or anywhere else you imagine. This guide works with any AI assistant you already use, and you don't need any special skills, just the ability to type a few sentences.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant you can type into.** Use ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Le Chat, or any other chatbot you have an account with. A free plan is enough.
- **A device with internet access** — phone, tablet, or computer all work.
- **About five minutes** for the first try.
- **Three small pieces of information** to feed the assistant: your child's first name, a sidekick (a pet, stuffed animal, or imaginary friend), and one favorite place.

That's it. No special software, no payment needed for the basic version, no technical knowledge.

Step 1 — Open a fresh chat with your AI assistant

Go to the website or app of the AI assistant you use, and **start a new, empty conversation**. Most assistants put a big button or a "**New chat**" option at the top of the screen. If you don't see that, look for a **pencil icon**, a **plus sign**, or a button that says something like **"New conversation"** or **"Start new chat"**. A blank chat is important because the assistant should focus only on your story — old messages from a previous chat can confuse it. 💬 Example: nothing to type yet — just open the app and tap the new-chat button. You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box with no earlier messages above it.

Step 2 — Tell the assistant what role you want it to play

In that empty message box, type one short sentence that asks the AI to act as a **bedtime story writer**. A **prompt** is just the instruction you give an AI — think of it like asking a friend to help. Asking the AI to play a specific role helps it write in the right style: gentle, warm, and suitable for kids. If the button on the screen is labeled something like **"Send"**, **"Ask"**, or has a **paper**

airplane icon ✈️, that's the one to press after you type. 💬 Example: `You are a kind bedtime story writer for young children. Please write in simple, gentle language with a happy ending.` You'll know it worked when the assistant replies confirming the role, often with a sentence like "Sure, I'd love to help!" or a short acknowledgment.

Step 3 — Add the three key ingredients: the child, the sidekick, the place

Now send a second message that names who is in the story and where it happens. Keep it short and specific — the more detail you give, the more personal the story feels. A **sidekick** is just the character's helper or best friend in the adventure. Include your child's first name, the sidekick (their pet, a teddy bear, or even an imaginary dragon), and one favorite spot (the backyard, the playground, grandma's house). If your assistant uses different button names, look for a **send arrow**, a **return/enter key**, or a circle with an upward arrow. 💬 Example: `Please write a story starring my 6-year-old daughter Lily, her hamster named Biscuit, and their backyard with the big oak tree. Lily is shy but very curious.` You'll know it worked when the assistant starts writing a story that mentions Lily by name within the first few sentences.

Step 4 — Ask for a bedtime-friendly length and a gentle lesson

Every AI can write short or very long stories. For bedtime, a short one works best so your child doesn't get restless. Send another short message asking for a story that takes about five minutes to read aloud, with **one soft lesson** woven in — like being brave, sharing, or trying something new. A **lesson** here just means a small, kind idea the story quietly teaches, not a lecture. If the assistant gives you a story that's too long, just say "shorter, please" and try again — there's no penalty for asking. 💬 Example: `Please make it about 500 words long — the length of a 5-minute bedtime read — and gently show how being brave helps, without being preachy.` You'll know it worked when the story comes back at roughly the right length and ends with a calm, peaceful feeling rather than a cliffhanger.

Step 5 — Read it, then ask for changes

Read the story out loud to yourself. If a part feels off — a character does something scary, a word is too hard, or the ending feels rushed — tell the assistant what to fix. This back-and-forth is normal and is how you **collaborate** with the AI (meaning you work on it together, taking turns). You might ask for a different ending, swap the sidekick for a unicorn, or add a sibling. The assistant rewrites the whole story in seconds. If the assistant offers choices like **"Regenerate"** or **"Try again"**, those are buttons that produce a fresh version using the same instructions. 💬 Example: `This is lovely, but please change the ending so Lily and Biscuit fall asleep peacefully under the oak tree instead of running home.` You'll know it worked when the new version includes your requested change and still has Lily's name in it.

Step 6 — Save or share the story

Once you're happy, copy the story into your phone's notes app, email it to yourself, or print it. Some assistants let you **share** the whole conversation through a **link** (a web address you can send to someone) — look for a **share icon**, which often looks like an arrow pointing up out of a box, or three connected dots. You can also screenshot the story page. The same prompt will work again tomorrow with different names, so you've just learned a skill you can repeat every night.
💬 Example: tap the **share icon**, choose **"Copy link"** or **"Send to email"**, and save the story in a folder called "Bedtime stories." You'll know it worked when the story is saved somewhere you can find it again, even after you close the chat.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to start a fresh chat.** Old messages can leak into the new story and confuse the assistant. If your story suddenly mentions your grocery list, that's why — open a new chat and try again.
- **Asking for too much at once.** "Make it exciting, funny, scary-but-not-too-scary, with songs and a dragon" overwhelms the assistant. One or two clear requests per message works much better.
- **Skipping the read-aloud test.** Stories that look fine on screen can sound clunky when spoken. Always read it once out loud before reading it to your child — your ear catches problems your eyes miss.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You have a free, endless supply of personalized bedtime stories. The same trick works for birthday parties, long car rides, or "I'm bored" afternoons — change the names and place.
- **For your business or work:** This same prompt technique — asking an AI to play a role, then giving clear ingredients — is the foundation of using AI for emails, reports, and lesson plans. You've just practiced the most important AI skill there is.
- **If you're just getting started:** You've now used an AI assistant for something creative, fun, and useful. That feeling of "I made this work" is the same feeling you'll have the next time you try something new with AI.

Try it now

Open your AI assistant right now, start a new chat, and paste this single message to get your first story in under a minute:

```
You are a kind bedtime story writer for young children. Please write a 500-word bedtime story starring my child named [YOUR CHILD'S NAME], their pet [PET NAME], set in [FAVORITE
```

```
PLACE]. Make it gentle, end with them falling asleep peacefully, and quietly show that being brave is good.
```

Replace the three bracketed parts with real details, hit send, and read the result out loud. That's your first custom bedtime story — and the start of a habit you can repeat as many nights as you like.

How to organize a chaotic shared family calendar in one afternoon

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Pick one calendar app everyone can see, create a shared family calendar, and spend about two hours adding every school event, work shift, and after-school practice. After that, set phone reminders so nobody asks "where am I supposed to be?" at 7am.

It is 6:47 on a Tuesday morning. Someone is hunting for a permission slip. Someone else is asking whether soccer practice got moved. The dog needs to be walked before anyone leaves. This is the moment a shared family calendar was invented for, and you can build one this afternoon while the kids are at practice and the laundry is running.

Before you start

- A free calendar app that everyone in the household can install: Google Calendar (works on Android, iPhone, and any browser), Apple iCloud Calendar (built into every iPhone and Mac), or Outlook Calendar (if your household lives on Windows or uses Outlook at work). All three have a free tier and let several people see and edit the same calendar.
- Each person's phone, signed in to the same account family members will share. (Children do not need their own email — they can appear as a placeholder once you add them.)
- A rough 90–120 minutes for the first pass. Updating after that takes about 10 minutes a week.
- A rough list of recurring commitments. Skim the school newsletter, the team schedule email, and your work rota — you will copy-paste these in Step 4.

Step 1 — Pick one calendar app the whole family will actually open

Open the calendar app that is already on your phone, or install one from your app store. If your family uses Android phones and a Windows computer, Google Calendar is usually the easiest because the free Google account it lives on is also what Android expects. If everyone has an iPhone, Apple iCloud Calendar works without any extra sign-up. If your workplace runs on Microsoft, the Outlook calendar keeps work shifts and family events in the same place.

Pick the option that matches what your family already uses — the best calendar is the one nobody has to remember to open. Sign in on your own phone and confirm you can see your existing events before moving on.

💬 Example: *"We have three iPhones and a Mac — let's use Apple iCloud Calendar so we don't have to install anything new."*

You'll know it worked when you open the app and see your existing appointments, birthdays, or that empty workweek you have been ignoring.

Step 2 — Create a new calendar called "Family"

Inside the app, look for a way to add a new calendar. On Google Calendar this lives behind the plus icon next to "Other calendars" in the left sidebar on the web; in Apple Calendar on Mac it is under the `File` menu; in Outlook it is `Add calendar → Create new`. The exact wording varies by app and device, but every major app has an "add calendar" button somewhere.

Name it clearly — "Family" works well. Pick a bright color so it stands out from your work calendar the moment you open the week view.

💬 Example: *"Calendar name: Family. Color: orange. Description: shared with mom, dad, Mia, and Leo."*

You'll know it worked when the new calendar appears in your sidebar with its own color and is empty.

Step 3 — Invite each family member to the new calendar

Now share the new calendar. In Google Calendar on the web, hover over the calendar name and look for a settings or share option, then add each family member's email. In Apple Calendar on Mac, look for a "Shared Calendar" toggle in the calendar info panel and paste iCloud email addresses. In Outlook, right-click the calendar and pick "Sharing and permissions". If you cannot find the exact button, search the app's help for "share calendar with family" — most apps walk you through it in two taps.

Each person accepts the invite on their phone. For younger children, add a placeholder name like "Mia (kid)" rather than creating a real account — they only need to see the events, not own them.

You'll know it worked when each person's phone shows the family events you add in the next step, usually within a minute or two.

Step 4 — Add the big repeating events first

Now the satisfying part. Think of the calendar as four layers and tackle them in order. Start with the hardest layer — fixed weekly commitments — because they happen every week and never change. Add soccer practice every Tuesday and Thursday, school assembly every Monday morning, your partner's shift pattern, your own standing meetings. Each app lets you set an event to repeat: look for a phrase like "Does not repeat" and change it to "Weekly" or "Custom" with the right days.

Set a reminder on each one. Most apps default to 10 minutes before, which is too short when you are getting three kids out the door. Look for the reminder setting and push it to 60 or 90 minutes, plus a second alert 15 minutes before.

Example: *"Tuesday 16:00–17:30, Soccer practice, Mia. Repeats every Tuesday. Reminder: 90 min before (popup) and 15 min before (notification)."*

You'll know it worked when the first event shows up on the shared calendar for everyone and a reminder pops up on your phone before the activity starts.

Step 5 — Add one-time events from this week's emails

Open your email and your partner's email (with permission, or just ask them to forward the relevant ones). School newsletters, dentist appointments, the birthday party on Saturday — copy each one into the shared calendar as a single event. If it has a location, add it. If the email includes a sign-up link or a note, paste the link into the event's notes or description box.

This step is messy the first time, and that is fine. The point is not perfection — it is getting the next 14 days out of everyone's head and onto one screen.

Example: *"Saturday 14:00–16:00, Leo's birthday party at the community center. Notes: RSVP link — bring a swimsuit."*

You'll know it worked when you can ask "what is on Thursday?" and tap the family calendar to find the answer in three seconds.

Step 6 — Set a 10-minute Sunday review habit

A shared calendar only stays calm if someone owns it. Pick one person — usually the one who already notices missed permission slips — to spend ten minutes every Sunday adding the next two weeks. Treat it like brushing your teeth: small, regular, easy to skip if you are tired.

Set a recurring reminder on your own phone: "Sunday 19:00 — family calendar check". Open the calendar, scan for missing items, add them, done.

Example: *"Sunday 19:00–19:10, Family calendar review, repeats weekly. Reminder: at start time."*

You'll know it worked when Sunday-night panic about forgotten events quietly stops happening.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the color step.** Without a clear color for the family calendar, events blend into your work calendar and you still do not see them. *Fix:* pick the brightest color the app

offers and use it only for family events.

- **Setting reminders 10 minutes before.** That is enough time to read a notification, not enough time to find a shoe and leave the house. *Fix:* set a long lead reminder (60–90 min) plus a short one (10–15 min) on every important event.
- **Forgetting the partner's work shifts.** If shift work runs your house, an unshared shift calendar quietly undoes everything. *Fix:* ask your partner to share their work calendar with yours, or add the recurring shifts to the family calendar in Step 4.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the Tuesday-morning "where am I supposed to be?" texts disappear, and quiet Sundays get a little less tense.
- **For your business or work:** the same habit — a single shared calendar with proper reminders — protects meetings from double-bookings the same way it protects carpools.
- **If you're just getting started:** do Steps 1–4 today and stop there. The rest can wait until Sunday.

Try it now

Open the calendar app on your phone, create one event called "Soccer practice — Mia" for next Tuesday at 16:00, set a reminder 90 minutes before, and share it on the new family calendar. That single event is your proof the system works — the rest is just more of the same.

Turn a photo of your fridge into two simple dinner ideas with Meta AI

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Meta AI can look at a photo of your fridge and suggest dinner recipes based on what it sees. Snap a wide picture, attach it to a Meta AI chat, and ask for two simple recipes — it usually returns ingredient lists, steps, and any items you'd need to buy.

Open the fridge, see half an onion, some eggs, and a slightly suspicious block of cheese, and have no idea what to cook. Sound familiar? This guide walks you through sending one photo of your fridge to Meta AI and getting two dinner ideas back, plus a quick shopping list for whatever you're missing. It's written for anyone who has never used Meta AI before — no special cooking or tech skills needed.

Before you start

- A free Meta account. Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, or Messenger all work.
- A smartphone with one of those apps installed, **or** a browser open to the official Meta AI page.
- Roughly 5–10 minutes, including taking the photo.
- Meta AI isn't available in every country, and a few features may differ by region — if you can't find it in one app, try another.
- One honest note up front: Meta AI can read the photo and suggest ideas, but it can't actually cook, and it sometimes misreads labels or skips an item. Treat its recipes as a starting point, not a final answer.

Step 1 — Open Meta AI in an app you already use

Pick the Meta app you use most — Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, or Messenger — and tap to open it. Once you're on the main screen, look around for a Meta AI entry point. It might look like a colorful circle icon, a search bar with "Ask Meta AI" written inside it, or a chat-style option near your other conversations. Tap whichever one you spot.

If it looks different on your device: Meta AI is being added to these apps in stages, so the exact placement changes often. If you don't see it inside the app, open your browser and go to the official Meta AI page instead — the experience is similar.

You'll know it worked when a chat screen opens with a place to type a message, usually along the bottom of the screen.

Step 2 — Take one clear photo of your fridge

Stand in front of your open fridge with your phone's camera app open. Take a single wide photo that tries to capture as many items as possible — shelves, drawers, the door. Don't worry about neatness; Meta AI just needs to see what's there. Try to avoid bright lights behind you that would darken the fridge, and hold the phone steady for a second so the picture isn't blurry.

If it looks different on your device: Some phone cameras have a "wide" or "0.5x" option. Use it if you can — fitting more into one shot means fewer ingredients get missed.

You'll know it worked when you can clearly read labels and recognize each item when you look at the photo later.

💬 Example: a quick self-check — ask yourself, "Could a friend tell what each thing is from this picture alone?"

Step 3 — Attach the photo and ask for two simple recipes

In the Meta AI chat, look for an attachment icon — usually a paperclip, a "+" symbol, or a small picture icon near the message box. Tap it, pick your fridge photo from the gallery, and wait a moment for the image to upload. Then type your request in plain language. Be specific: how many recipes you want, how much time you have, and any food you want to avoid.

If it looks different on your device: On some apps you can take the photo directly inside the chat using a camera icon, instead of choosing one from your gallery. Either way works.

You'll know it worked when the photo appears as a small preview in the chat, and Meta AI starts typing a reply.

💬 Example: "Here's what's in my fridge. Please suggest two simple dinner recipes I can make tonight in under 30 minutes. I don't eat pork."

Step 4 — Refine the suggestions to fit your evening

Read through what Meta AI sent back. Often the first response is close but not quite right — maybe it suggests something spicy when you don't want spice, or a recipe that takes an hour when you only have 20 minutes. Just reply in the same chat with one short follow-up explaining what to change. Meta AI will adjust the plan.

If it looks different on your device: If the response stops mid-sentence or seems cut off, just send "Please continue" and it usually picks up where it left off.

You'll know it worked when the updated recipe matches what you actually have time, taste, and ingredients for.

💬 Example: "I don't have an oven. Can you give me a stovetop version of the second recipe?"

Step 5 — Ask for a short shopping list of what's missing

Once you've picked a recipe you like, type one more short message asking what you'd need to buy. Meta AI compares the recipe against what it spotted in your photo and gives you a list. Ask it to keep the list short and grouped by aisle if you can — it makes the actual shopping trip faster.

If it looks different on your device: If Meta AI says it can't tell what's missing, just paste the recipe ingredients yourself and ask, "Which of these aren't in my fridge?" — that's usually enough to get a clean list.

You'll know it worked when you have a small, specific list of items to buy, not a vague "various ingredients" answer.

💬 Example: "Please make me a short shopping list of everything I'm missing from these recipes. Group it by store section."

Step 6 — Save the recipes so you can find them while cooking

Once you're happy with the recipes and the shopping list, save them somewhere easy to reach with messy hands. On most phones you can take a screenshot of the chat, copy the recipe text into a notes app, or send it to yourself in a messaging app. The goal is to have it open on the counter without having to log in or scroll through a long chat history.

If it looks different on your device: If screenshots feel clunky, ask Meta AI in one final message to "summarize these recipes and the shopping list in a short format I can paste into Notes" — it usually gives you a clean block of text you can copy with one tap.

You'll know it worked when you can pull up the recipe and shopping list in under five seconds, even with flour on your fingers.

Common mistakes

- **Blurry, dark photo.** The single biggest reason Meta AI gets the recipes wrong is a hard-to-read photo. Open the fridge, turn on a kitchen light, and hold still for one second before tapping the shutter. If you can't read a label in the picture, Meta AI probably can't either.
- **Asking for too much at once.** "Give me five gourmet dinners with dessert and wine pairings" overwhelms the assistant. Stick to two recipes at a time, and ask for wine or dessert in a separate follow-up if you really want it.
- **Forgetting to mention what you don't eat.** Meta AI doesn't know you're vegetarian, allergic to nuts, or out of soy sauce. The first message is the place to say so — adding it later means re-asking and getting a slightly different recipe each time.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** it's a fast way to break the "I have nothing to cook" feeling on busy weeknights. Instead of staring at the fridge for ten minutes, you spend thirty seconds taking a photo and another minute reading recipes — the rest of the time goes back to your evening.
- **For your business or work:** if you run a small café, a meal-prep service, or write a food newsletter, this is a quick brainstorming partner for "what can I make with what's on hand right now?" It won't replace a recipe developer, but it can get you past a blank page fast.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is the very next time you're stuck on dinner — open Meta AI, snap the photo, and ask for two recipes. You don't need to learn anything else first.

Try it now

Open your fridge right now. Before you close the door, take one wide photo and send it to Meta AI with the prompt: *"Suggest two simple dinners I can make tonight in under 30 minutes with what's in this photo."* Read the first reply before you do anything else — that's the whole skill, and you already have it.

Drafting a Basic Family-Tree Outline with AI: A Beginner's Guide

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll have a plain-text family-tree sketch on your screen — parents, grandparents, siblings, cousins, the people you actually know — drafted for you by an AI assistant in about ten minutes. This is for anyone curious about family history who wants a simple starting point without filling in a full genealogy database on day one.

> **Honest note before you begin:** an AI assistant works in text, not in polished diagrams. What you'll get is a clean text outline (think of it like a typed list with indents and lines) that you can later paste into a free tree-drawing website if you want something visual. That's the real value of starting here — a tidy draft you can grow.

Before you start

- An account with any modern AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, DeepSeek, or similar. The free tier is fine.
- Five quiet minutes to memory-jog — names of parents, grandparents, aunts, uncles, and any cousins you remember. Dates and places aren't required.
- A notes app, a fresh document, or a notebook where you'll paste the final text.
- Roughly 10–15 minutes in total.

Step 1 — Jot down the relatives you actually know

Before you open any AI, take five minutes to list the people you're confident about. Grab paper or open a notes app. Write down: you; your parents and their first names; your grandparents on each side (maternal and paternal); your siblings and half-siblings if any; your aunts, uncles, and any cousins you remember. Don't worry about dates or places yet — names and relationships are enough to start a draft.

💬 Example: "Me — Sara. Parents: Mom = Linda, Dad = Tom. Mom's parents: Gran = Joan, Pop = Bill. Dad's parents: Nan = Margaret, Grandpa = Alan. Siblings: brother Jake. Aunts/uncles: Aunt Mary (Mom's sister), Uncle Rob (Dad's brother). Cousins: Lily (Aunt Mary's daughter)."

If your memory is hazy on a branch, just leave it blank and add it later. You'll know it worked when you have a rough list — even a messy one is a perfectly good place to begin.

Step 2 — Open any AI assistant and start a fresh chat

Open the website or app of your chosen assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, DeepSeek, or whichever you already use. Sign in if asked, then start a brand-new conversation. A

fresh chat matters because older messages can distract the AI. Look for a button like **"New chat"**, **"New conversation"**, or a small **pencil-and-paper icon**, usually near the top-left or top-right of the screen. Click or tap it once.

After the new chat opens, you'll see an empty text box waiting for your message. If your assistant offers different modes (like "Search" or "Thinking"), the default mode is fine for this task.

You'll know it worked when the screen shows a blank conversation with just the message box at the bottom and no previous replies hanging around.

Step 3 — Send a clear, structured prompt

Click or tap inside the message box and type a short request that includes your list from Step 1. Tell the AI you want a family-tree outline drawn with text — using indents, dashes, or a simple tree shape made of letters and lines. Mention that you're after a starting draft, not a finished genealogy chart, and that you'll fill in gaps later. Then send the message by pressing **Enter** or tapping the **paper-plane / up-arrow icon**.

💬 Example: "Here's my family as I know it: me (Sara), Mom Linda, Dad Tom, brother Jake, Mom's parents Joan and Bill, Dad's parents Margaret and Alan, Aunt Mary (Mom's sister) and her daughter Lily, Uncle Rob (Dad's brother). Please draw a simple text-based family tree outline with three generations — me, parents, grandparents — using indents or a basic tree shape. Note any branches I haven't filled in. This is just a starting draft."

You'll know it worked when the AI replies with a formatted block of text showing people organized by generation, instead of just a flat sentence listing names.

Step 4 — Review the draft and ask for fixes

Read the AI's reply carefully. The first draft is almost never perfect — a name might be on the wrong line, a relative might be missing, or the formatting might be hard to read. Don't worry. Simply reply in the same chat and tell the AI what to change. Be specific: name the person, say where they belong, and how you want them shown. The AI works best with concrete instructions, not vague feedback like "make it better".

💬 Example: "Thanks. Please move Aunt Mary to sit under Mom's parents as their daughter, and add a cousin called Lily as her child. Also use dashes and greater-than symbols (├── └──) instead of dots so it copies cleanly into my document."

You'll know it worked when the AI sends a revised version that matches what you asked for. Keep tweaking until the structure feels right — two or three small rounds is normal.

Step 5 — Ask for an export-friendly version

Once the structure looks right, ask the AI for one final version that's easy to paste into a notes app, an email, or a text file. Mention you want plain text only — no special fonts, no images, no fancy code blocks that might break when pasted. Most assistants can produce a clean version in seconds. If you want a proper visual chart later, this text version can be copied into a free online tree-drawing site, but for now the text itself is your family-tree sketch.

💬 Example: "One more version please — same tree, but plain text only, no markdown or code blocks, so I can paste it straight into my notes app without fixing the formatting."

You'll know it worked when the AI's reply is plain text you can highlight, copy, and paste anywhere without formatting glitches or stray symbols.

Step 6 — Save your sketch and plan to grow it

Paste the final text into your notes app or a document and give the file a name you'll remember, like "Family tree — draft 1". This is your starting point. From here you can add more relatives over time — great-grandparents, in-laws, step-relatives, or children and nieces and nephews. Each time you add someone, return to the same AI chat (which still holds your earlier context) and ask for an updated version. The AI can also help you draft questions to ask older relatives, or summarize old letters and documents you find.

💬 Example: "Add these new people to the tree: my partner Sam, our daughter Mia, and Sam's parents Pat and Chris. Please show the in-law branch as a separate section so it doesn't get mixed up with my birth family."

You'll know it worked when you have a saved text file that grows each time you add to it, and you no longer have to keep everything in your head.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to start a fresh chat.** Older conversations can make the AI mix up unrelated topics. Always open a new chat for a new project.
- **Asking for too much in one go.** Asking for "every relative I might ever have, with dates and places" overwhelms the AI and gives a vague answer. Stick to what you actually know first.
- **Treating the AI's first draft as final.** It almost never is. Plan for two or three rounds of small fixes — that's normal and gives a much better result.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A simple family-tree sketch makes it easier to talk to older relatives about family history — you can show them what you already know and ask them to fill the gaps.
- **For your business or work:** If you work in genealogy, heritage research, or local history, a quick AI-drafted outline is a fast starting point before investing in a proper database tool.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't worry about being thorough on day one. A messy draft with the names you remember is a perfectly good place to begin — you can add detail whenever you like.

Try it now

Spend five minutes jotting down the names you know — parents, grandparents, siblings, one or two aunts or uncles. Then open any AI assistant you already use, start a new chat, and paste the example prompt from Step 3 with your own list filled in. You'll have your first family-tree sketch before your coffee goes cold.

Plan a 20-Minute Home Workout With Gemini (No Equipment Needed)

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Gemini can build you a custom 20-minute bodyweight routine in about a minute. You tell it your space, time, and energy level; it gives you a warm-up, main set, and cool-down you can follow on your phone.

Picture this: it's evening, you've been sitting for hours, and you have a small window before bed. No gym, no dumbbells, no time to drive anywhere. You just want to move for 20 minutes and feel better. That is exactly the kind of everyday problem Gemini is good at — you describe what you need in plain words, and it drafts a routine you can actually follow. This guide walks you through the conversation step by step.

Before you start

- A free Google account and access to Gemini, either through the Gemini app on your phone or tablet, or by visiting the Gemini website on a computer.
- About 20 square feet of space — a living room, bedroom corner, or hallway is plenty.
- Five minutes to chat with Gemini, then 20 minutes to do the workout itself. Total time: about 25 minutes.
- A way to time yourself — your phone timer, a kitchen timer, or a smart speaker works fine.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a fresh chat

Open the **Gemini app** on your phone, or go to the **Gemini website** in your browser. If you have used Gemini before, your old chats will be on the left side (or behind a **menu icon** ☰ on mobile). Tap the **"New chat"** button — usually a **pencil icon** or a **"+"** — so Gemini starts with a clean slate and won't get confused by older conversations. A blank chat screen appears with a text box at the bottom and a **send arrow** ➤. If you can't find the new-chat button, try logging out and back in, which also clears the slate. 💬 Example: no typing yet — just open the app or site. You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box and no previous messages on screen.

Step 2 — Tell Gemini what you have to work with

Tap inside the text box and type one short paragraph describing your situation. Gemini works best when you give it the basics in a single message: how much time you have, what equipment you do or don't have, and how your body feels today. After you tap send, Gemini reads your message and starts drafting a routine — usually within a few seconds. If your message is too

vague ("make me a workout"), Gemini may ask a follow-up question. If your message has the basics, it will jump straight to a list of exercises. Example: "Make me a 20-minute home workout. No equipment at all. I have a small living room and medium energy today — I want to actually move, but I'm not trying to set any records." You'll know it worked when Gemini replies with a list of exercises, or asks one short clarifying question before doing so.

Step 3 — Ask for a clear structure: warm-up, main, cool-down

If Gemini gives you a single block of exercises, ask it to break the routine into three labeled parts. This matters because going straight from sitting to jumping jacks is a recipe for a pulled something, and finishing with no stretching leaves you stiff. Tell Gemini roughly how long you want each part to take. It will rewrite the routine with clear headings. On screen you should see something like **"Warm-up (3 minutes)"**, **"Main set (14 minutes)"**, and **"Cool-down (3 minutes)"**, each with its own short list. Example: "Please split the workout into a 3-minute warm-up, a 14-minute main set, and a 3-minute cool-down. Put each section under a clear heading." You'll know it worked when you can scan the reply and see three separate sections with times or rep counts next to each exercise.

Step 4 — Mention anything your body needs you to adjust

Now is the moment to be honest about sore knees, a tight lower back, a shoulder that's been bothering you, or simply "I haven't moved much this week." Type a short sentence about it. Gemini will swap out exercises that don't fit and suggest gentler alternatives — for example, replacing burpees with step-back lunges, or sit-ups with dead bugs. You don't need medical language; just describe how your body feels. Gemini cannot see you or diagnose injuries, so if something hurts sharply, skip the move and trust your own judgment over the chat. Example: "My lower back is a little tight. Please avoid moves that load the spine, like burpees or sit-ups. Swap them for something gentler." You'll know it worked when the new version of the routine no longer contains the moves you asked to avoid, and the replacements look reasonable to you.

Step 5 — Make the routine easy to read while you exercise

Reading a wall of text while you're out of breath is annoying, so ask Gemini to format the main set as a numbered list you can scan. Each line should have the exercise name, the time or rep count, and a one-line cue (a short reminder like "knees soft" or "keep your back flat"). The reply will look cleaner — short lines, not paragraphs. If anything is still wordy, ask Gemini to make it even tighter. The goal is a routine you can glance at between sets without losing your place. Example: "Rewrite the main set as a numbered list. Each line: exercise, seconds or reps, one quick cue. I need to read this while I'm working out, so keep it tight." You'll know it worked

when you can scan the main set in under 10 seconds and tell what move is next without re-reading.

Step 6 — Save the routine so you can follow it hands-free

Once the routine looks good, take a screenshot, or copy it into your notes app, or use your phone's share button to send it to yourself. Now put your phone on the floor or a shelf where you can see it without holding it, set a 20-minute timer, and start the warm-up. Gemini's job ends here — it has planned the workout, but it cannot count your reps, watch your form, or push you to finish that last set. You do that part. If you want to switch things up next time, just open a new chat and tell Gemini what to change. Example: no typing — screenshot the routine or paste it into your notes. You'll know it worked when you can start your timer, glance at the screen once, and know exactly what to do for the next 20 minutes.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to mention your space or equipment.** If you don't say "small living room, no equipment," Gemini might suggest moves that need a pull-up bar or a lot of room to sprawl. Always say what you do and don't have.
- **Asking for "a hard workout" when you're actually tired.** Gemini designs for the energy level you describe. If you say "I want to push myself" but you're exhausted, you'll likely quit at minute eight. Tell it the truth — even "low energy, please be gentle" is useful input.
- **Trying to read a long paragraph while working out.** If the reply looks like a wall of text, ask for a numbered list before you start moving. A routine you can't scan quickly is a routine you won't finish.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** 20 minutes of movement that fits into a busy evening — between dinner and bedtime, after the kids are settled, or right after a long meeting. You don't need a gym, a plan, or motivation. You just need a chat with Gemini and 20 square feet of floor.
- **For your work or business:** the same chat format works for a 5-minute stretch break between meetings, or a standing-desk reset. You can reuse the routine for a week and then ask Gemini to refresh it.
- **If you're just getting started:** skip the chat entirely and do 20 minutes of walking in place, marching, gentle stretching, and a few squats. The point is to move; Gemini is a helper, not a requirement.

Try it now

Open Gemini right now and paste this: "Make me a 20-minute home workout. No equipment. I have a small living room and medium energy. Please split it into a warm-up, main set, and cool-down, and format the main set as a numbered list with seconds or reps and a quick cue for each move." Send it, then take a screenshot of the reply. You've just designed tonight's workout in under a minute.

How to Troubleshoot Your Home Wi-Fi Step by Step with an AI Assistant

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** An AI assistant can walk you through a technician-style checklist (restart, isolate the device, test the line, check the router) and help you figure out what's wrong before you spend an hour on hold with your internet provider.

When your Wi-Fi drops in the middle of a video call or your phone refuses to load anything, the temptation is to call your internet provider and wait. Most home Wi-Fi problems, though, follow a handful of common patterns, and a chatbot like ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude can walk you through the same diagnostic checklist a technician would use, in plain language, while you stand next to your router.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant you already use** — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, or any other chatbot. No special account or paid plan is required for this task.
- **Your phone or laptop**, so you can type to the assistant and run the steps it suggests.
- **Access to your Wi-Fi router** (the small box your internet provider installed). You'll need to be near it for some steps.
- **Roughly 15–30 minutes.** Most fixes happen in the first few minutes; the rest is just confirming what works.

Step 1 — Tell the AI exactly what's wrong

Open your AI assistant and describe the problem in one short paragraph. Mention when it started, which devices are affected, and what you've already tried. The clearer you are, the better the questions and suggestions it can give you back. If it asks follow-up questions, answer them — this is the AI narrowing down the cause, the same way a technician would. Example: "My home Wi-Fi has been cutting out for the past two days. My laptop loses connection every 20–30 minutes, but my phone stays connected fine. I haven't changed any settings. Where should I start?" You'll know it worked when the assistant responds with a short list of likely causes or a first diagnostic step, instead of a generic answer.

Step 2 — Run the "is it just this device?" check

Ask the AI: "How do I tell whether the problem is with one device or with the whole Wi-Fi network?" It will usually walk you through picking up your phone and seeing if it has internet. If your phone works fine on Wi-Fi but your laptop doesn't, the issue is probably the laptop, not your network. If every device is slow or offline, the problem is more likely the router or your

internet line. This one test saves a lot of wasted effort later. If your assistant doesn't ask, you can also try: "What should I check first to narrow down whether it's my device, my router, or my internet provider?" You'll know it worked when you can say out loud which of the three it probably is — device, router, or provider.

Step 3 — Restart the router the right way

Ask the AI to guide you through restarting your router properly. The correct method is: unplug the power cable, wait a full 60 seconds (so the internal memory clears), then plug it back in. Wait another two or three minutes for the lights to settle. Look for a button or a small recessed hole labeled "reset" — do **not** press that one, it wipes your settings. A regular power cycle fixes a surprising number of home Wi-Fi problems. If your router has a power button instead of a cable, hold it down until the lights go off, wait 60 seconds, then press it again. You'll know it worked when the lights on the router return to their normal pattern (usually one steady "internet" light) and your devices reconnect automatically.

Step 4 — Test the actual internet speed and signal

Ask the AI: "How do I check my current internet speed and Wi-Fi signal strength from home?" It will point you to a free speed test site (you can type something like "speed test" into any search engine to find one) and explain that you should run the test once near the router and once in the room where you usually use the internet. A big difference between the two numbers means the Wi-Fi signal is weak in that spot — often solved by moving the router higher, away from walls, or off a metal shelf. If both numbers are low even near the router, the problem is likely your provider's line. You'll know it worked when you have two speed numbers (one near the router, one where you usually sit) and a rough idea whether the slowdown is the signal or the line.

Step 5 — Ask the AI to interpret the results

Copy the numbers and what you observed back into the chat and ask, "Based on this, what should I try next?" This is where the assistant earns its keep — it can usually tell you whether to move the router, change the Wi-Fi channel, switch from the 2.4 GHz to the 5 GHz band, or accept that the line itself is the problem. If you see a phrase like "channel congestion" or "5 GHz band" for the first time, ask the AI to explain it in plain words before you change anything. A good chatbot will gladly translate its own jargon. You'll know it worked when the assistant gives you one or two concrete next actions, instead of a long list of possibilities.

Step 6 — Decide whether to call your provider

Ask one last question: "Based on everything we've checked, does this sound like something I can fix myself, or should I contact my internet provider?" Be honest about what you've found — the

assistant can only help if you tell it the truth. If the speed test was bad right next to the router, the Wi-Fi works on your phone but not your laptop, or every device has been down since a storm, those are useful details to share. When the AI says it's time to call, write down the two or three key things you tried, because the person on the phone will ask. You'll know it worked when you have either a working Wi-Fi connection, or a clear short summary you can read to the support agent so you don't have to start from zero.

Common mistakes

- **Pressing the tiny "reset" hole on the router by accident.** That wipes your settings and you'll need your provider's login details to set it up again. Power-cycle by unplugging instead, and only use the reset hole if the AI specifically tells you to.
- **Restarting only the router and not the device.** If your laptop still won't connect after the router is back, restart the laptop too. Stale network settings on the device are a common silent cause.
- **Trusting a speed test taken on Wi-Fi from far away.** A slow number in the far room tells you the signal is weak, not that your provider is slow. Move closer to the router before you blame anyone.
- **Letting the AI guess instead of asking.** If an answer feels vague, reply with more detail about what you actually saw — lights, error messages, devices affected. The clearer the input, the better the diagnosis.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time your Wi-Fi drops during a movie, a game, or a work call, you can spend ten minutes running through this checklist before deciding whether to call support — and you'll know exactly what to say when you do.
- **For your business or work:** if you work from home, a slow or unreliable connection can quietly cost you hours a week. Having a fast self-diagnosis routine means fewer dropped calls and less time spent waiting on hold while deadlines slip.
- **If you're just getting started:** the single easiest first move is to bookmark one AI assistant on your phone, so the next time something breaks you can open it in seconds instead of searching blindly.

Try it now

Open your favorite AI assistant right now and type: "My Wi-Fi keeps dropping on one device. Can you walk me through how to figure out whether it's the device, the router, or my internet provider?" Read the first three suggestions it gives you — that's your personal starting checklist the next time something goes wrong.

Plan a week-long trip itinerary with Copilot from a simple destination list

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Tell Copilot Chat the cities you want to visit and the dates you're free, and it will draft a day-by-day plan that includes travel time between stops. You need a free GitHub account, and you should double-check train, bus and opening-hour details yourself before booking anything.

Planning a one-week itinerary is one of those tasks that feels simple but turns into a long spreadsheet. GitHub Copilot — the AI assistant made for code — also has a chat mode (think of it as a chat box inside GitHub or VS Code) that handles everyday questions like this. It's a slightly off-label use, but it works well for first drafts. Here's how to use it for a trip.

Before you start

- A **GitHub account** (free at github.com — sign-up takes about two minutes).
- A way to reach **Copilot Chat**: in a browser at github.com/copilot, or inside VS Code if you already use it. The free tier has a monthly usage limit that's usually plenty for a one-off planning chat; if you hit it, you'll see a clear message.
- A short list of the places you want to visit — even rough is fine.
- Your travel dates and a general sense of pace (relaxed vs packed).
- About **15 minutes** from first click to a printable plan.

Step 1 — Open Copilot Chat in your browser

Go to **github.com/copilot** and sign in with your GitHub account. After signing in, look for a chat box — usually labeled "Ask Copilot" or something similar — at the top or side of the page. Click inside it. The cursor blinks in an empty text field, and the rest of the page fades back slightly to show the chat is the active area. If you use VS Code, the same chat lives in the sidebar under the Copilot icon; the steps below work the same way. **If it looks different:** the exact label and position of the chat box change often, so look for a rounded rectangle that says "Ask", "Chat", or "Copilot". A new chat session is now active and waiting for your first message.

💬 Example: type a single word first to confirm it works, like "hi". You'll know it worked when Copilot replies with a short greeting.

Step 2 — Set the scene with one short sentence

Before you paste your list, write a one-line brief so Copilot knows the tone you want. Treat it like briefing a friend who's helping you plan. State who's traveling, how long you have, and what

kind of trip it is. A line of context up front usually gives you a more useful first answer than jumping straight into the city list. The reply may simply acknowledge — that's fine; the goal is to set expectations before the real ask.

💬 Example: "I'm planning a relaxed 7-day trip for two adults in October, and we love food, walking, and quiet neighborhoods." You'll know it worked when later replies reference your tone or pace, not just generic tourist spots.

Step 3 — Hand over your destination list and dates

Now paste the city list in plain English. The clearer your dates and the order you'd like to visit in, the more accurate the plan. You don't need exact addresses — cities, regions or neighborhoods are fine. If you already have a rough order, say so ("I'd like to start in X and end in Y"). Copilot reads the whole message as one go and starts building a structure from it, so put everything you want considered in this single message.

💬 Example: "Cities I'd like to visit: Lisbon, Sintra, Porto, Coimbra. Dates: 5 to 11 October. Start in Lisbon, end in Porto. We have a rental car." You'll know it worked when the next reply is a numbered day-by-day breakdown, not a single clarifying question back to you.

Step 4 — Ask for travel time between each stop

After the first draft, send a follow-up that explicitly asks for **travel time between stops**. This is the part most people forget, and it's where Copilot is genuinely useful — it can roughly estimate drive, train or bus times so you don't accidentally schedule a six-hour drive into a half-day stop. Be clear about how you'll actually travel, because the same two cities can be 30 minutes apart by train and three hours by road.

💬 Example: "Can you add the approximate travel time between each city by car, and flag any day where the drive eats more than 3 hours? Suggest a faster option if one exists." You'll know it worked when each transition line now includes something like "≈ 1h by train" or "≈ 2h30 drive".

Step 5 — Refine with your real preferences

The first draft will be generic — that's normal. Now ask for the changes that matter to you: pace, food, kid-friendliness, walking limits, budget, time of year. One preference at a time works best; long "and also…" lists tend to produce messy replies. Think of it like editing a draft document with a colleague: small, focused comments in sequence.

💬 Example: "Please slow down Day 3 — one museum, one long lunch, and a sunset walk. We don't want to be on our feet for more than four hours." You'll know it worked when the revised day fits the new constraint and doesn't just pile on more activities.

Step 6 — Save the plan and double-check the moving parts

Once you're happy, ask Copilot to format the final itinerary as a clean list or table so you can copy it into Notes, Google Docs or an email. Then **always verify anything that moves or costs money**: train times, museum opening hours, restaurant reservations. Copilot can guess these, but it doesn't have real-time schedules, so the plan is a first draft, not a travel agent. One last sanity-check question helps: ask for the slowest day in the plan and confirm it actually feels relaxed.

💬 Example: "Can you give me the final itinerary as a Markdown table with columns for Day, Morning, Afternoon, Evening, and Travel Time?" You'll know it worked when you can paste the output straight into another app without cleanup, and when every transit line has a number you can sanity-check online.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for too many cities at once.** Six cities in seven days usually produces a rushed, joyless plan. Cap it at four or five for a relaxed trip; let Copilot spread them out.
- **Trusting train times and opening hours blindly.** Copilot drafts plausible schedules — they may be wrong. Cross-check with the operator's website before you book.
- **Forgetting to mention how you'll travel.** The plan changes a lot between "by car", "by train" and "on foot". Add this in Step 3, not later, or the travel times will be invented.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A weekend getaway, a road trip with friends, or a family visit across two or three cities — same process, smaller scale and faster results.
- **For your business or work:** Conference travel, offsite planning, or a multi-stop client visit where you want a structured agenda before you start booking hotels and trains.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try a small one first. A 48-hour plan for two cities is the easiest way to see how Copilot handles this kind of task before you trust it with a bigger trip.

Try it now

Open github.com/copilot, sign in, and ask: "Plan a relaxed 2-day weekend in [your nearest big city] for someone who likes coffee, books and walking." See what it gives you in one reply — that's your baseline.

Use Le Chat to Turn a Long Recipe into a Simple Shopping List

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste a recipe with roughly twelve ingredients into Le Chat, ask it to build a grouped shopping list, and copy the result to your phone before you head to the store. It usually takes under two minutes, and you don't need a paid plan. Note: Mistral now calls this assistant **Vibe** (formerly Le Chat) — you may see either name in the app and on mistral.ai.

You're standing in the kitchen holding your phone, scrolling past a recipe with ingredients scattered across two paragraphs of backstory. You want a clean shopping list — now, not in twenty minutes. Le Chat, the chat assistant from the French AI company Mistral, can turn that wall of text into a tidy, grouped list you can tick off aisle by aisle. This guide shows you exactly how to set that up, even if you've never opened an AI assistant before.

Before you start

- **A free Le Chat account.** Sign up at `chat.mistral.ai` with an email or a Google account. The free plan covers this task fully — you don't need to pay.
- **A recipe.** Pick any recipe with around a dozen ingredients. A long one from a food blog or a cookbook page works best, because the messier the original, the more obvious the time savings.
- **About five minutes.** Two minutes to paste and ask, two or three to tweak the list, and maybe a minute to copy it to your notes app.
- **A phone or computer.** Le Chat works on both. If you're heading to the store right after, use your phone so you can copy the list straight into Notes, Google Keep, or any list app you already use.

A small honest note before we start: Le Chat can organize and reword the ingredients for you, but it can't check your pantry or merge two recipes into one. If you want to combine three recipes into a single list, you'll need to paste them together as one message — see Step 4 for that variation.

Step 1 — Open Le Chat and start a new chat

Go to `chat.mistral.ai` in your browser, or open the Le Chat app if you already installed it. On the home screen, look for a **button labeled "New chat"** — usually at the top-left of the screen, sometimes shown as a square plus icon in the corner of the sidebar. Click or tap it once.

You'll see a fresh, empty chat window with a text box near the bottom and a paperclip or attachment icon next to it. The blank box is where you'll paste the recipe. If you can't see a "New

chat" button, look for a pencil icon or a chat-bubble with a plus sign — apps shift these around between updates.

💬 Example: if you're on the home screen and unsure, type anything short like "hi" first to confirm the chat box is responsive.

You'll know it worked when the page shows an empty conversation with no previous messages, and the text box cursor blinks at the bottom — ready for you to paste in.

Step 2 — Paste the full recipe into the chat box

Open your recipe on the same screen or in another tab, highlight every line of ingredients (including the measurements — "2 cups flour", "1 tbsp olive oil", "a pinch of salt"), and copy it. Then click into Le Chat's empty text box and paste. On a phone, long-press inside the box and tap **Paste**.

You'll see the recipe appear as a block of text inside your message bubble — usually in plain monospace style. The whole ingredient section should fit, even if it's long, because Le Chat handles long messages well. If your recipe includes images of the dish, don't paste those — just the text of the ingredients.

If it looks different: on the phone app the text box might sit behind the keyboard at first. Tap inside it once so the keyboard rises, then paste. On desktop, the standard `Ctrl+V` (Windows) or `Cmd+V` (Mac) works as expected.

You'll know it worked when the recipe text sits in your message bubble, still highlighted or unhighlighted but visible, and the send arrow (→) or paper-plane icon lights up in the corner of the box.

Step 3 — Ask Le Chat to build a grouped shopping list

Now write a short instruction under the pasted recipe (or as a new message right after it — both work). Tell Le Chat exactly what shape of list you want: grouped by store section, no extra commentary, and copy-paste friendly. Be specific — the more concrete your ask, the cleaner the output.

You'll see a "Thinking…" or pulsing dots indicator for a few seconds, and then Le Chat replies with a formatted list. It usually uses headings like **Produce**, **Dairy**, **Pantry**, and bullet points under each — but the exact groups depend on the ingredients, so don't be surprised if "Spices" or "Frozen" shows up for one recipe and not another.

💬 Example prompt you can copy and adapt:

> "Group these ingredients into a shopping list by store section (produce, dairy, meat, pantry, spices, frozen). Show quantities. Give me just the list — no intro paragraph, no tips, no closing line. Use simple bullet points I can copy into my notes app."

You'll know it worked when the response is mostly bullet points and headings, with no extra explanation paragraphs around them. If you see a friendly sentence like "Here's your list!" before the list, that's fine — just delete it when you copy.

Step 4 — Tweak the list or combine recipes

This is the optional moment to adjust. Look through the list and check two things: are the quantities right, and do any items overlap? If you're combining two recipes, paste the second one below the first in the same message (or as a follow-up) and ask Le Chat to merge them into one list with quantities added together.

On screen, Le Chat rewrites the list with the merged quantities — for example, three recipes each calling for "1 onion" become "3 onions" on one line. If a recipe says "a handful of cilantro" and another says "2 tbsp chopped cilantro", Le Chat usually picks one and notes the difference. Read it over — this is the moment to fix anything that looks off.

If it looks different: if Le Chat's reply is in a long paragraph instead of bullets, your prompt wasn't specific enough. Send a follow-up like "Reformat as bullet points only, no sentences." It will redo it.

You'll know it worked when you can read the whole list in under thirty seconds, every quantity is a number you trust, and nothing important is missing. If something's wrong — wrong unit, wrong amount, missing item — type the fix as a quick follow-up: "Change 200g butter to 1 stick" or "Add 1 lime to produce."

Step 5 — Copy the list to your phone and head out

Highlight Le Chat's reply (or just tap **Copy** if your browser offers a copy button on the code-style blocks), then open your notes app — Apple Notes, Google Keep, Samsung Notes, or even a plain text message to yourself. Paste it in.

You'll see the headings and bullets come across cleanly in most modern notes apps. Some apps flatten the bullets into plain lines, but the structure (Produce / Dairy / etc.) usually survives as section titles. Pin the note to the top of your list so it's the first thing you see in the store.

If it looks different: in Safari on iPhone, you may need to use **Share → Select All → Copy** instead of dragging to highlight, because long AI replies can be tricky to grab. In the Le Chat mobile app, look for a small **copy icon** at the top-right of each AI message — tap it once and the whole reply goes to your clipboard.

You'll know it worked when the list is on your phone, readable at a glance, with store sections as headers and quantities next to each item. Walk into the store, tick items as you drop them in the cart, and toss the note when you get home.

Common mistakes

- **Asking without a format.** "Make me a shopping list" usually gives a paragraph of ingredients. Always say *grouped by section, bullet points only, no intro or outro* — otherwise you'll spend more time editing than you saved.
- **Forgetting the quantities.** Le Chat can summarize measurements ("a pinch", "to taste") or drop them entirely. If you care about exact amounts, add to your prompt: *"Keep the quantities — don't drop '1 tbsp' or '200 g'."*
- **Trusting the list blindly.** AI assistants occasionally misread a measurement (1 tbsp can become 1 tsp). Spend ten seconds scanning the list before you leave — it's faster than walking back to the store for a missing ingredient.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a friend sends you a link to "the best lasagna ever," you can have a printed-and-ready shopping list in two minutes flat. It also works for meal prep — paste four dinner recipes at once and Le Chat merges them into one master list for the week.
- **For your work or business:** if you run a small café, catering side-business, or a cooking class, this same trick turns any recipe PDF into a clean prep list for your team. The "no intro, no closing, bullet points only" format becomes a reusable prompt you keep in a note.
- **If you're just getting started:** don't worry about prompt engineering. One sentence — *"Group by store section, keep quantities, bullet points only"* — is enough to get a usable list nine times out of ten. Iterate from there.

Try it now

Pick a recipe you've been meaning to cook. Open `chat.mistral.ai`, paste the ingredients, and send this exact prompt:

> "Group these ingredients into a shopping list by store section. Keep quantities. Bullets only, no intro or closing."

Copy whatever Le Chat gives you into your notes app. That's the whole flow — and from now on, every recipe you save is two minutes away from the store.

How to Write a Personalized Bedtime Story for Your Child Tonight

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open any AI assistant, type your child's name, their favorite animal, and tonight's mood, and you'll get a fresh 5-minute bedtime story in under a minute. Read it yourself or have the AI read it aloud — most assistants do this on a free plan.

This guide is for any parent, grandparent, or caregiver who wants a brand-new bedtime story tonight without writing one from scratch. No storytelling experience needed — just a phone, laptop, or tablet and about ten minutes.

Before you start

- **Any AI assistant** you already use — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, and DeepSeek all work. If you don't have one yet, pick any of them and sign up on their website (most offer a free tier — check the official pricing page for current plan details).
- A device you can read on, ideally one that can also speak aloud (any phone or laptop with speakers).
- About 10 minutes total — 2 minutes to type the prompt, 2 minutes for the story to arrive, 5 minutes to read it.
- One honest note up front: the AI will draft the story, but it can't replace you reading it. Kids settle faster when a familiar voice does the reading — the AI just gives you the words.

Step 1 — Open your AI assistant and start a new chat

Open the app or website of the AI you usually use. If you've never used one, go to the homepage of any major assistant and create a free account — look for a button like **Sign up** or **Get started** in the top-right corner. Once you're in, start a fresh chat by looking for a **New chat** button or a + icon, usually at the top-left of the sidebar. You'll see an empty text box with a blinking cursor waiting for your question.

💬 Example: you don't need to type anything yet — just confirm the empty box is there.

If the assistant opens straight into an old conversation, scroll up or look for **New chat** in the sidebar. On a phone, the + or pencil icon usually sits at the top of the conversation list.

You'll know it worked when you see a blank chat screen with a text box ready for typing.

Step 2 — Type the story prompt with your child's details

Click into the text box and write a request that includes three things: your child's name, their favorite animal, and the mood you want tonight (calm, brave, silly, sleepy). You can also add a setting — a forest, the moon, under the sea — if your child has one. Keep it short and natural; the AI will fill in the rest.

Example: "Write a 5-minute bedtime story for my 5-year-old named Maya. Her favorite animal is a fox. Tonight she needs to feel brave because she's starting daycare tomorrow. Set it in a moonlit forest. Use simple words. End with Maya falling asleep smiling."

After you press Enter (or the **Send** arrow), the assistant starts typing its reply within a few seconds. You'll see words appear one chunk at a time — that's normal, not an error.

If the language comes out too advanced for your child's age, add a line like "use words a 4-year-old knows" and try again. If it spells the name wrong, just double-check the spelling in your original prompt and re-send it.

You'll know it worked when a story of roughly 300–500 words appears on screen, with your child's name and the animal woven through it.

Step 3 — Read it together and ask for tweaks

Read the story aloud to your child, or read it silently first if you want to check it. If a line feels off — too scary, too long, mentions something your child doesn't know — just type a follow-up request in the same chat. The assistant remembers the story, so you don't need to start over.

Example: "Make the fox a little funnier, and cut the part about the dark cave — Maya doesn't like caves."

Within seconds, a new version appears below your message. You can do this as many times as you like. If you want it shorter, type "make it 3 minutes instead of 5." If you want a rhyme, type "rewrite it as a rhyming poem."

If the assistant starts drifting away from the story (suggesting books to buy or adding random facts), politely say "please rewrite only the story, no extra tips." That usually fixes it.

You'll know it worked when your child smiles, asks a question about the fox, or asks to hear it again — all three are good signs.

Step 4 — Have the AI read it aloud (optional)

If you want a hands-free version, look for a **speaker icon**, a **Read aloud** button, or a **Play** triangle near the assistant's reply. On some apps this sits at the bottom of the message; on others

it's tucked inside a ⋯ menu or a small icon next to the text. Tap it, and the assistant reads the story in a synthetic voice while you hold the teddy bear.

Example: tap the speaker icon, then say to your child, "Want to hear what the fox says?"

If you can't find a speaker icon, copy the story (long-press then **Copy**, or use **Ctrl+C** / **Cmd+C**) and paste it into a separate text-to-speech app on your phone. Most phones have one built in — look in your settings for something called **Read Aloud**, **Spoken Content**, or **Text-to-Speech**.

You'll know it worked when you hear a voice reading the story and your child looks up from their toys.

Step 5 — Save the story so you can use it again

If your child loved it, save the chat. Most assistants keep your conversations automatically, but it's worth giving the chat a name you'll recognize later. Look for a way to **rename** the chat — usually a pencil icon next to the chat title in the sidebar — and call it something like "Maya's brave fox story." Next week, you can come back and type "tell me another story about Maya and the fox, this time she's learning to share" to get a sequel.

Example: rename the chat "Maya's brave fox night 1."

If you want a printable copy, copy the final story text into a notes app, an email to yourself, or a document. Some assistants also have a **Share** button (an arrow pointing up or a link icon) that lets you send the story to yourself or to a co-parent.

You'll know it worked when you can find the chat again tomorrow by name, and your child recognizes "their" fox.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for too much at once.** "Write a 30-minute epic with three villains and a plot twist" overwhelms the AI and your child. Stick to one mood, one animal, and one small moment — five minutes is plenty for bedtime.
- **Skipping the read-aloud check.** The AI sometimes slips in a sentence that's too complex or a little spooky. Always skim the story once before you start reading it to your child.
- **Forgetting to rename the chat.** Without a clear name, you'll scroll through dozens of conversations trying to find "the fox one" next week. Take five seconds at the end to rename it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Bedtime stops being a negotiation about which book to read for the hundredth time. You get a fresh story every night, and your child gets to be the hero of it.
- **For a tired caregiver:** When you don't have the brainpower to make up a story at 9pm, the AI carries the writing. You still do the cuddling, the silly voices, and the "one more chapter" — that part is yours.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try it once with the example prompt in Step 2, swapping in your own child's name and favorite animal. That's the whole learning curve.

Try it now

Open any AI assistant on your phone, type this prompt (filling in the blanks): "Write a 5-minute bedtime story for my [age]-year-old named [name]. Their favorite animal is a [animal]. Tonight they need to feel [mood]. Set it in [place]. Use simple words and end with [name] falling asleep smiling." Read it to your child tonight — no prep, no printing, no pressure.